CryptAlyst

Books, Models & Data

The decoupled streaming forecast architecture
— messaging, streaming, models, books, data and history —
and how they combine to continuously forecast and fire tier signals.

At a glance	
Architecture	async · decoupled · bus-driven
Messaging	STOMP envelopes · epoch ts · TTL · no backlog
Streaming	Binance WebSocket · never poll · BPF filter-at-source
Models	10 calculation agents · pure functions
Books	account + bounded signal intel window
Strategy	lock · trail · stop · clock ladder
Runtime	pure Go · goroutines
Diagrams	35 · rendered in the CryptAlyst role palette

CryptAlyst — Books, Models & Data

The decoupled streaming forecast architecture

> *A complete engineering review of the platform: how **messaging, streaming, models, books, data and history** combine to continuously forecast and fire **tier signals** that strategies trade. Every diagram is rendered in the CryptAlyst role palette.*

Contents

1. The core principle
2. Messaging — the bus
3. Streaming — never poll
4. Models — calculation agents
5. Books — account and intel
6. Data — the market microstructure
7. Forecast → tier signal → trade
8. The strategy and exit ladder
9. Pure Go — concurrency
10. The full journey
11. The envelope and pipeline
12. The topic registry
13. The risk governor
14. The evolution
15. Model reference — the ten agents in detail
16. Worked examples — bull run, refusal, a full trade
17. Data signals — depth, OI, volume
18. Correlation and lineage
19. Book states
20. The recorder and the lake
21. The supervisor and control plane
22. Example trades — stop, trail, cascade, funding
23. Risk accounting
24. The envelope journey
25. Tier decisions
26. Design decisions — why it is built this way
27. The forecast — how the layers combine
28. The Go code structure
29. More worked examples
30. Operations and monitoring
31. Testing the models
32. The complete topic registry
33. Glossary
34. Summary

How to read this document

Each section builds on the previous one, but every section also stands alone.

- **Sections 1–6** establish the pieces: the principle, the bus, the streaming, the models, the books, the data.
- **Sections 7–13** show the flow: forecast → tier signal → trade, the exit ladder, the Go concurrency, the journey, the envelope, the topic registry, the risk governor.
- **Sections 14–25** are the reference: the evolution, each model in detail, worked examples, the data signals, the lineage, the states, the recorder, the supervisor, the risk.
- **Sections 26–34** are the reasoning and the operations: why it is built this way, the forecast math, the code structure, more examples, monitoring, testing, the full registry, and the glossary.

How to read a diagram. Every diagram uses the CryptAlyst role palette:

Colour	Role
blue	market data (raw feed)
green	intelligence (TA, forecast, signals)
amber	models, books, strategies
red	risk, refusals
teal	control, orchestration
purple	stores, the lake
grey	the bus, envelopes, neutral

The colour tells you *what kind of thing* a node is at a glance, before you read a single label. Flow runs left-to-right or top-to-bottom; sequence diagrams run top-to-bottom over time.

Appendix A — the exit ladder in code

The ladder is four checks, in order, on every mark:

```
switch {
case chg >= +0.35:
    reason = "lock"                          // bank a fee-clearing profit
case peak >= +1.0 && chg <= peak-0.5:
    reason = "trail"                         // ride the winner, exit on a pullback
case chg <= -0.5:
    reason = "stop"                          // cap every loss
case held >= 180 && chg > 0:
    reason = "clock"                         // force turnover on winners
}
```

Appendix B — a model rule in code

`rsi2` is the whole model: a pure function of candles, nothing else.

```
func rsi2(bs []Candle) string {
    cl := closes(bs)
    if len(cl) < 3 { return "" }
    r := rsi(cl, 2)
    if r < 10  { return "buy"  }
    if r > 90  { return "sell" }
    return ""
}
```

It holds no state, reads no account, and knows nothing about who consumes its output. That purity is what makes it testable — and what makes it a *calculation agent* rather than a trading loop.

Appendix C — the imbalance in code

```
imb = (bid_volume - ask_volume) / (bid_volume + ask_volume)
if |imb| > 0.3:
    side = buy if imb > 0 else sell
```

One number, from the order book, is the whole curve-rider signal — the BPF "keep only the signal" idea applied to market data.

1. The core principle

The platform is **asynchronous and decoupled**. Nothing calls anything else directly.

- **Models are calculation agents** — they publish *numbers* (a signal, a score, a probability).
- **The bus carries packets** — every message is an envelope with an **epoch timestamp and a TTL**, and it is **never backlogged**: subscribers read the latest state, nothing queues.
- **Books hold the intel** — a book accumulates the recent signal stream in a **bounded rolling window**, so a model can see a *pattern* before it is confident.
- **Strategies trade** — a strategy lives inside the book and opens/closes only when the model has confirmed a pattern.

A single signal is not enough. A model reports a signal, is *not sure* whether it is a good idea, and waits until it sees a **pattern**. **That intel is what the book carries and the model uses.**

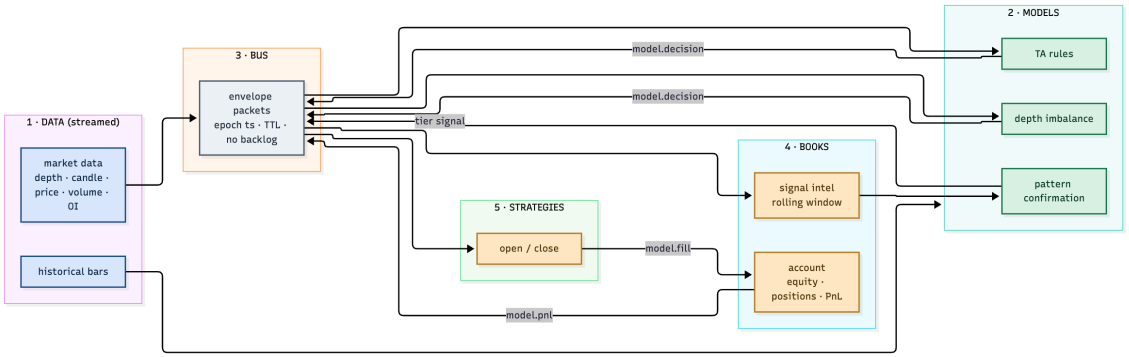


Figure 1.1 — data → models → bus → books → strategy → trade, decoupled at every hop.

1.1 Why decouple

Coupled (what we moved away from)	Decoupled (the design)
a model opens a position directly	a model only publishes a number
one slow model slows everything	each model owns its own goroutine
a panic in one model kills the pipeline	a panic is contained and reported
models only run when the loop runs	models run continuously, whether or not anyone listens
consumers read whatever arrives	consumers read the latest state (TTL, no backlog)

The decoupling is what makes the system *agile*: a packet of model output or market data can be published, listened to, and used by any other part — without any part knowing who listens.

2. Messaging — the bus is the nervous system

Every message on the bus is an **envelope**: a payload plus metadata — the provenance that makes the stream auditable and fresh. The bus is a **state channel, not a job queue**: with a TTL on every packet and no backlog, a subscriber always reads the *current* picture, and old packets simply evaporate.

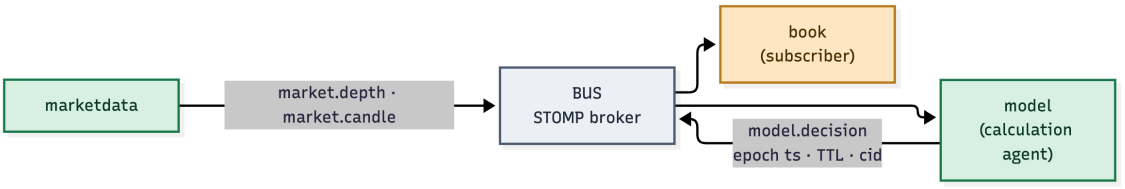


Figure 2.1 — calculation agents publish numbers; subscribers listen and decide.

2.1 The envelope anatomy

```
flowchart TD
    E["envelope"] --> D["data — the payload"]
    E --> M["meta — version · plane · producer · epoch ts · TTL · cid"]
    E --> R["refs — topic · key · generation · age_ms"]
```

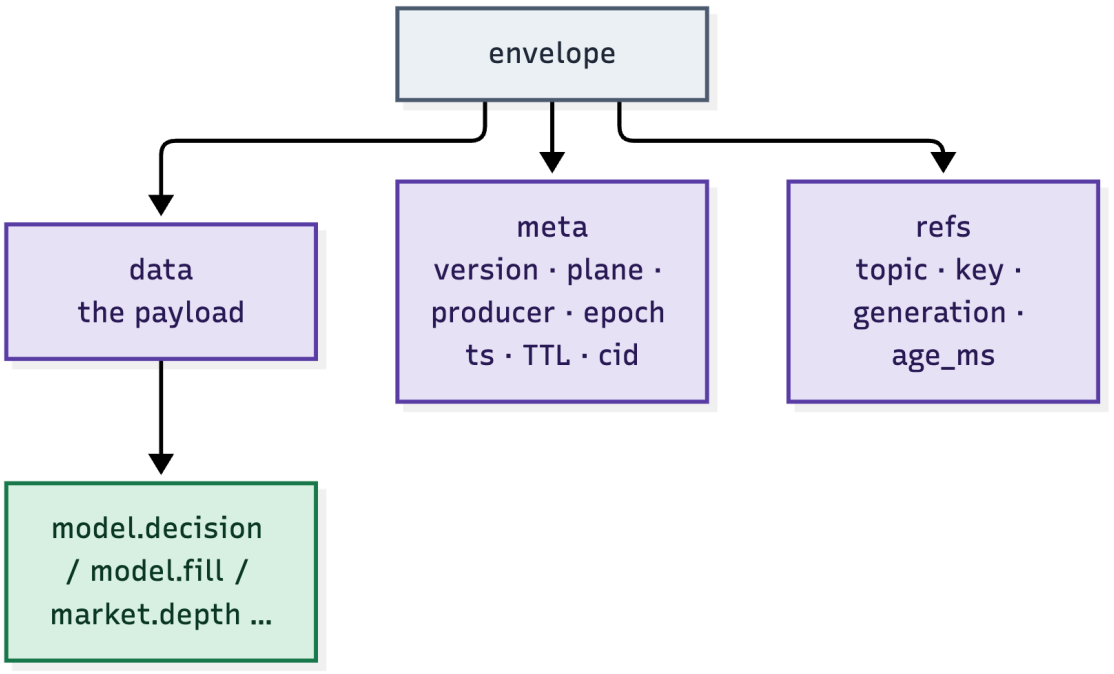


Figure 2.2 — an envelope carries the payload, its provenance, and the inputs it read.

Member	What it carries	Why it matters

`data`	the payload for the topic	the number the model computed
`meta`	version, plane, producer, generation, cid, timestamps	provenance — who, when, in what order
`refs`	the inputs it read (topic, key, generation, age)	lineage — what a decision was based on

2.2 The metadata fields

Field	Meaning
`version`	the envelope contract revision
`plane`	market, intel, model, risk, control, system
`topic`	the channel (e.g. `model.decision`)
`key`	the symbol, when the message concerns one
`producer`	the component that computed the payload
`generation` / `seq`	monotonic ordering per topic
`cid` / `parent_cid`	correlation id — links a decision to its fills
`computed_at`	when the payload was produced (staleness gates use this)
`received_at`	when the recorder accepted it
`hops` / `refs`	the pipeline stages and the inputs read

2.3 The pipeline — interceptors, operator, transformer

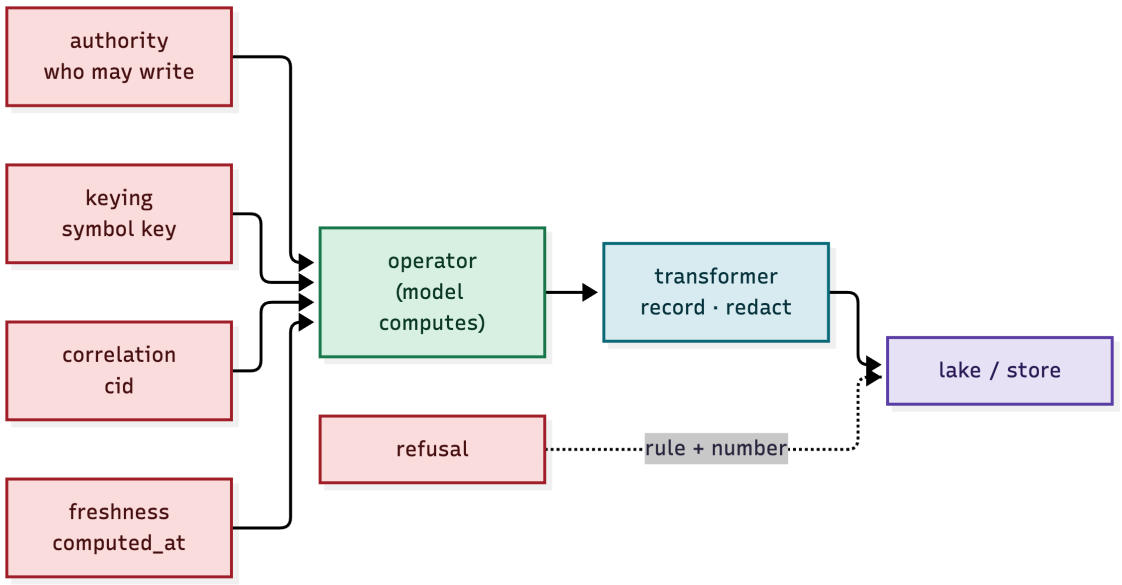


Figure 2.3 — authority, keying, correlation and freshness run before the operator produces a payload.

Every envelope passes four interceptors before the operator runs, and a transformer after:

Stage	What it checks	Refusal records
`authority`	the producer may write this topic	the rule name
`keying`	the message is keyed by symbol	the rule name
`correlation`	a cid is minted and chained	the rule name
`freshness`	`computed_at` is within the topic's limit	the rule and the number

A refusal is recorded as an envelope too — so "why not" is a packet you can open, not a line in a log.

2.4 Topics — a single registry with producer contracts

`topics.go` is the **one table**. Each topic declares its exchange, its producers and its retention (TTL). The planes group them:

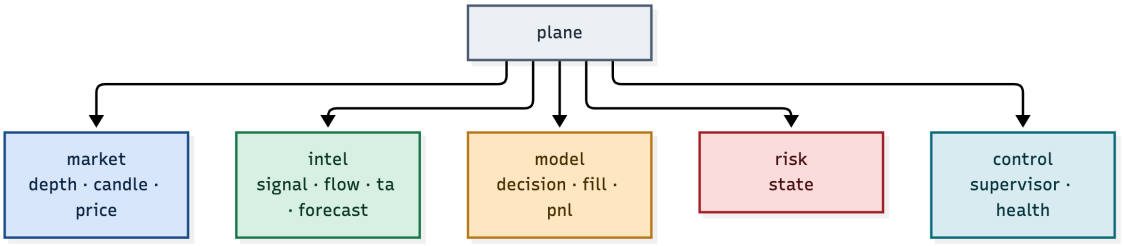


Figure 2.4 — five planes: market, intel, model, risk, control.

Topic	Exchange	Producers	Retention
`market.price` / `market.depth` / `market.candle`	market	market_data	drop (live only)
`intel.signal` / `intel.flow` / `intel.movers`	intel	signals	60s
`intel.ta`	intel	tad	60s
`intel.forecast`	intel	forecast	60s
`model.decision`	model	models10, curve_rider, …	5m
`model.fill`	model	same	5m
`model.pnl`	model	same + supervisor	5m
`risk.state`	risk	risk	5m

3. Streaming — never poll (BPF-inspired)

The Berkeley Packet Filter filters packets **at the source** — inside the kernel — so only the data that matches is ever copied up. The same idea applied to market data:

1. **Filter at the source** — subscribe to only what we need (`depth5` , not the full book).
2. **Keep only the signal** — collapse the order book to one `imbalance` number.
3. **Never poll** — data pushes to us over WebSocket; decisions happen on arrival.

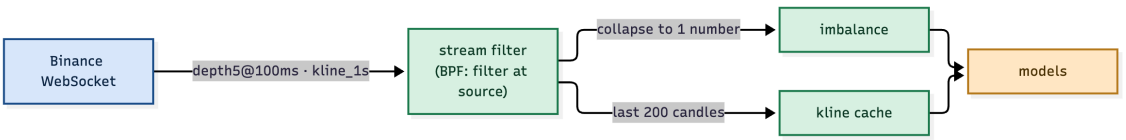


Figure 3.1 — WebSocket → filter → one number, the BPF pattern.

3.1 Why streaming beat polling

Measured during the build: **one model calculation takes ~150 µs**, while **one HTTP fetch takes ~333 ms** — the network was ~2000× slower than the math. Polling 24 endpoints sequentially cost ~8 seconds per decision; the WebSocket stream delivers the same data in real time.

Before (poll)	After (stream)
24 sequential HTTP fetches ≈ 8s per decision	push, ~0 latency
full depth (20 levels)	depth5 (5 levels) + one imbalance number
stale data on a timer	data on arrival

The bottleneck was never the language — it was I/O and polling.

3.2 What is streamed

Stream	Frequency	What it feeds
`depth5@100ms`	100 ms	the imbalance (book pressure)
`kline_1m` / `kline_15m`	on close	the TA models
`bookTicker`	real time	the best bid/ask
`trade` / `aggTrade`	real time	volume and taker flow

The market data service subscribes once, and every model reads the same live state.

4. Models — calculation agents that publish numbers

A model owns **one question**. It does not know about accounts, positions, or risk. It computes and publishes — which is what makes it replaceable and testable.

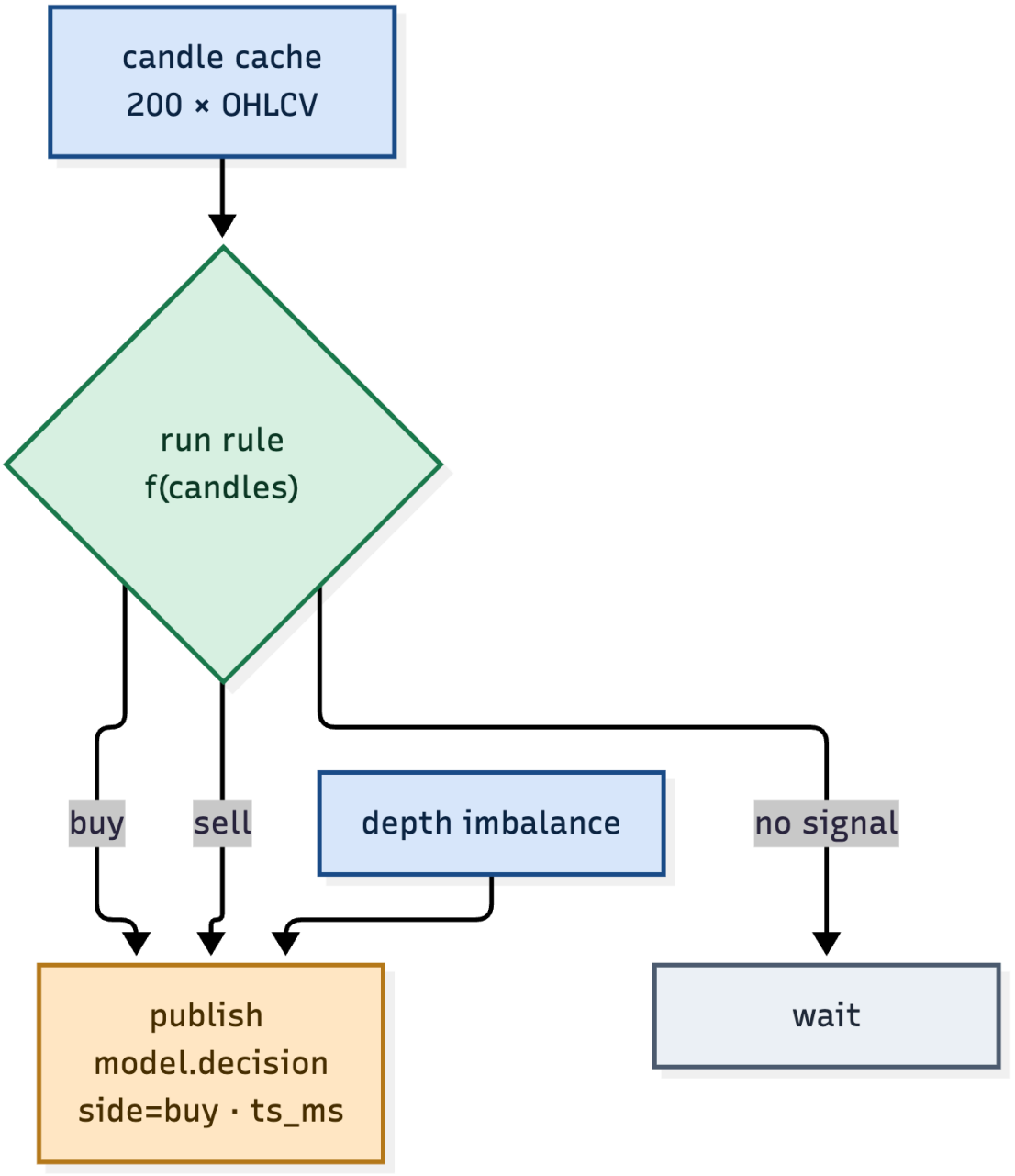


Figure 4.1 — the model consumes the cached market state, runs its rule, and publishes a decision.

4.1 The models

Model	Question	Rule

`donchian55`	breaking a 55-bar range?	close ≥ 55-bar high → buy; ≤ low → sell
`orb`	breaking the opening range?	close > session high → buy; < low → sell
`boll_squeeze`	tight Bollinger expanding?	close > +2σ with width < 1% → buy
`rsi2`	2-bar RSI stretched?	RSI < 10 → buy; > 90 → sell
`vwap_revert`	stretched from VWAP?	below 0.994×VWAP → buy; above 1.006× → sell
`macd_trend`	MACD crossed zero?	hist crosses up → buy; down → sell
`vol_break`	volume spike + directional close?	vol > 3×avg + close in top/bottom 30% → trade
`ema_pullback`	pullback to the EMA trend?	price at EMA20 with EMA20>EMA50 → buy
`atr_channel`	outside an ATR channel?	close > EMA20+1.5×ATR → buy
`curve_rider`	strongest book imbalance?	buy/sell the biggest bid/ask imbalance

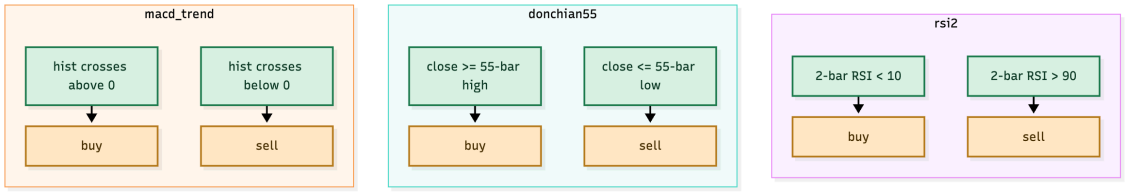


Figure 4.2 — RSI2, Donchian and MACD: each is a tiny deterministic function of candles.

4.2 Models feed other models

A model's output is input to another. A **positioning** model publishes where the book is exposed; a **risk** model consumes it and publishes risk; both feed the decision. **Models provide valuable data for other models** — and the bus is how that data moves without any model knowing who listens.

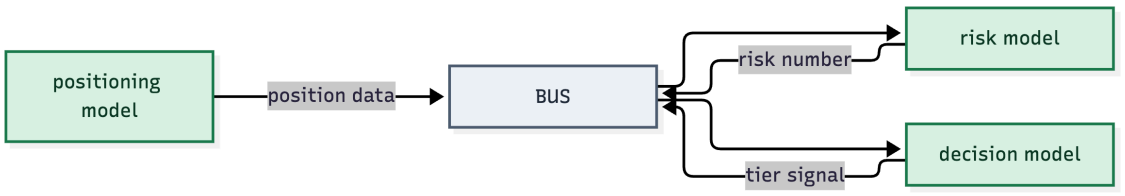


Figure 4.3 — positioning → risk → decision, each a published number.

5. Books — account and intel

The book is two things at once:

1. **The account** — equity, open positions, realised PnL. This survives and is reported.
2. **The intel** — a bounded rolling window of recent signals, so the model can see a *pattern* rather than a lone blip.

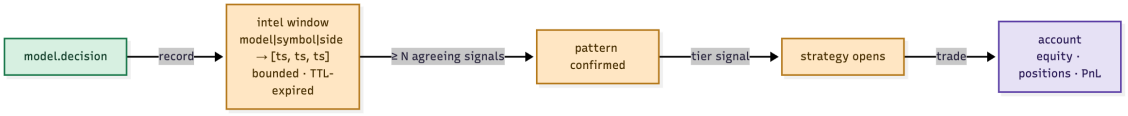


Figure 5.1 — a lone signal is noise; the streak in the window is the signal.

5.1 The pattern confirmation

Models need **previous signals, or many**, to make an informed decision. The book holds those for a **time window the model defines**:

- a signal arrives — the model is *not sure* yet;
- the book records it in the rolling window;
- only when **N agreeing signals** accumulate inside the window does the model confirm;
- the confirmation becomes a **tier signal** the strategy may act on.

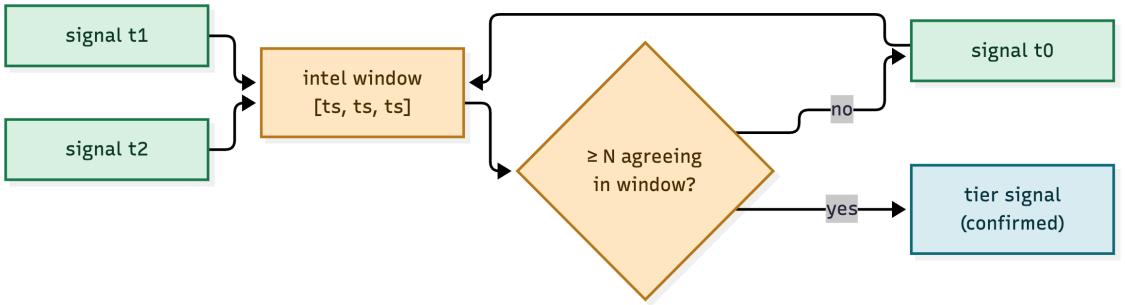


Figure 5.2 — a signal is reported; the model waits for a pattern before it is sure.

"Never hold too much data, but imagine a bull run." The window is bounded — old entries expire — yet it is long enough that during a sustained move the model sees the *streak* of agreeing signals that confirms the trend. A single signal is noise; the **streak** is the signal.

6. Data — the market microstructure

A forecast is only as good as the data behind it. The system reads the order flow, not just the candles:

Signal	Reads	What it reveals
depth imbalance	bid vs ask volume	real buy/sell pressure now
OI change	open interest over an interval	new money entering
price	last / 24h move	direction + momentum
volume	quote volume / spike	participation and conviction

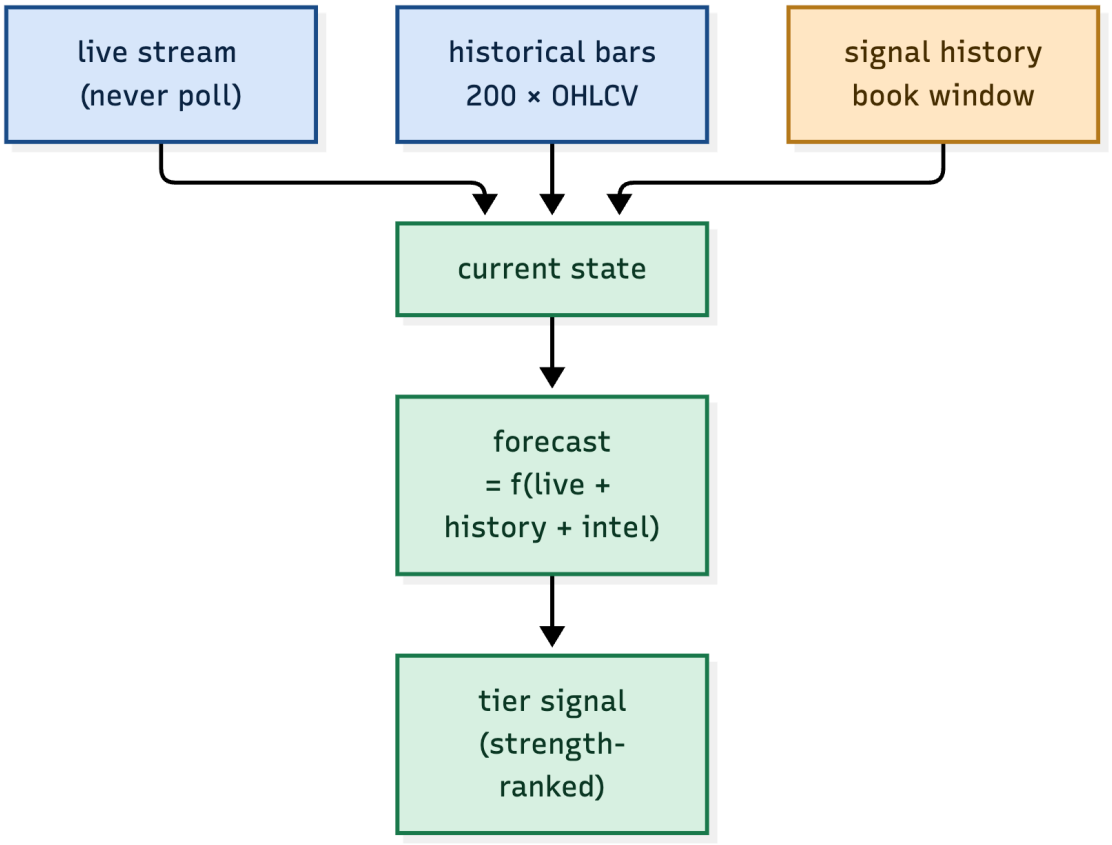


Figure 6.1 — three layers combined turn a number into a forecast.

6.1 The three layers of data

Layer	What it provides	Why it matters
Live stream	the *now* — imbalance, last price, last volume	direction of pressure
Historical bars	the *context* — 200 bars of OHLCV	where price is in its range

Signal intel	the *memory* — recent model outputs	whether a pattern is forming

All three combined turn a number into a *forecast*, and a forecast into a **tier signal**.

7. Forecast → tier signal → trade

The strategy does not act on every number. It waits for a **tier signal** — a confirmed, strength-ranked decision.

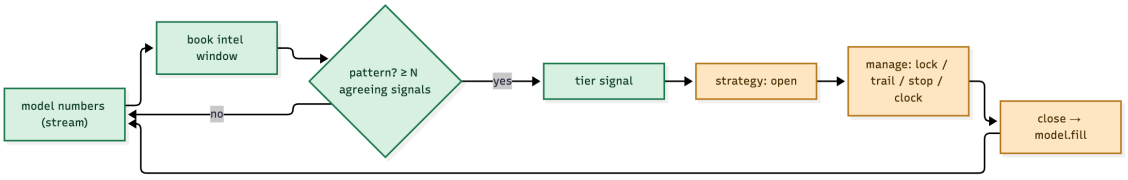


Figure 7.1 — numbers → pattern → tier signal → open → manage → fill.

7.1 Tier ranking

Not all signals are equal. The system ranks them by strength and acts accordingly:

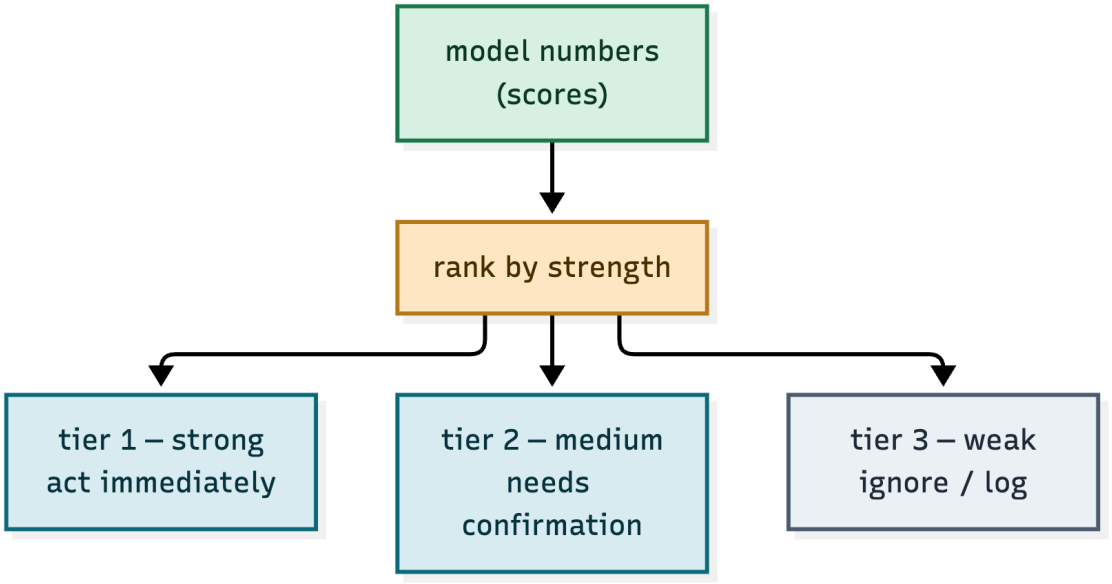


Figure 7.2 — tier 1 acts immediately, tier 2 needs confirmation, tier 3 is ignored.

Tier	Meaning	Action
Tier 1	strong, confirmed	act immediately
Tier 2	medium	needs further confirmation
Tier 3	weak	ignore / log only

8. The strategy and exit ladder

Once a tier signal is confirmed, the strategy opens a position and manages it on a fixed ladder. The ladder is the risk envelope that keeps losses bounded and lets winners run.

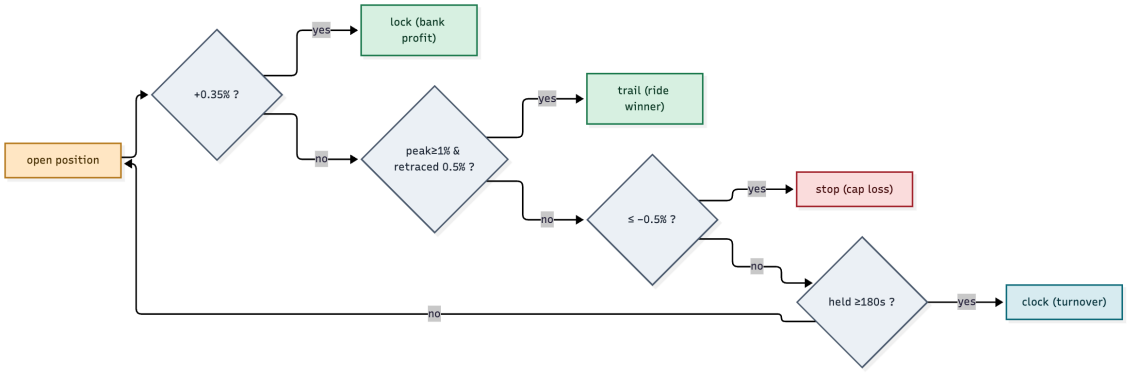


Figure 8.1 — four exits, checked in order, on every mark.

Exit	Rule	Purpose
`lock`	+0.35%	bank a fee-clearing profit
`trail`	peak ≥ +1%, exit −0.5% off peak	ride winners
`stop`	−0.5%	cap every loss (no heavy bleeds)
`clock`	180s hold, winners only	force turnover

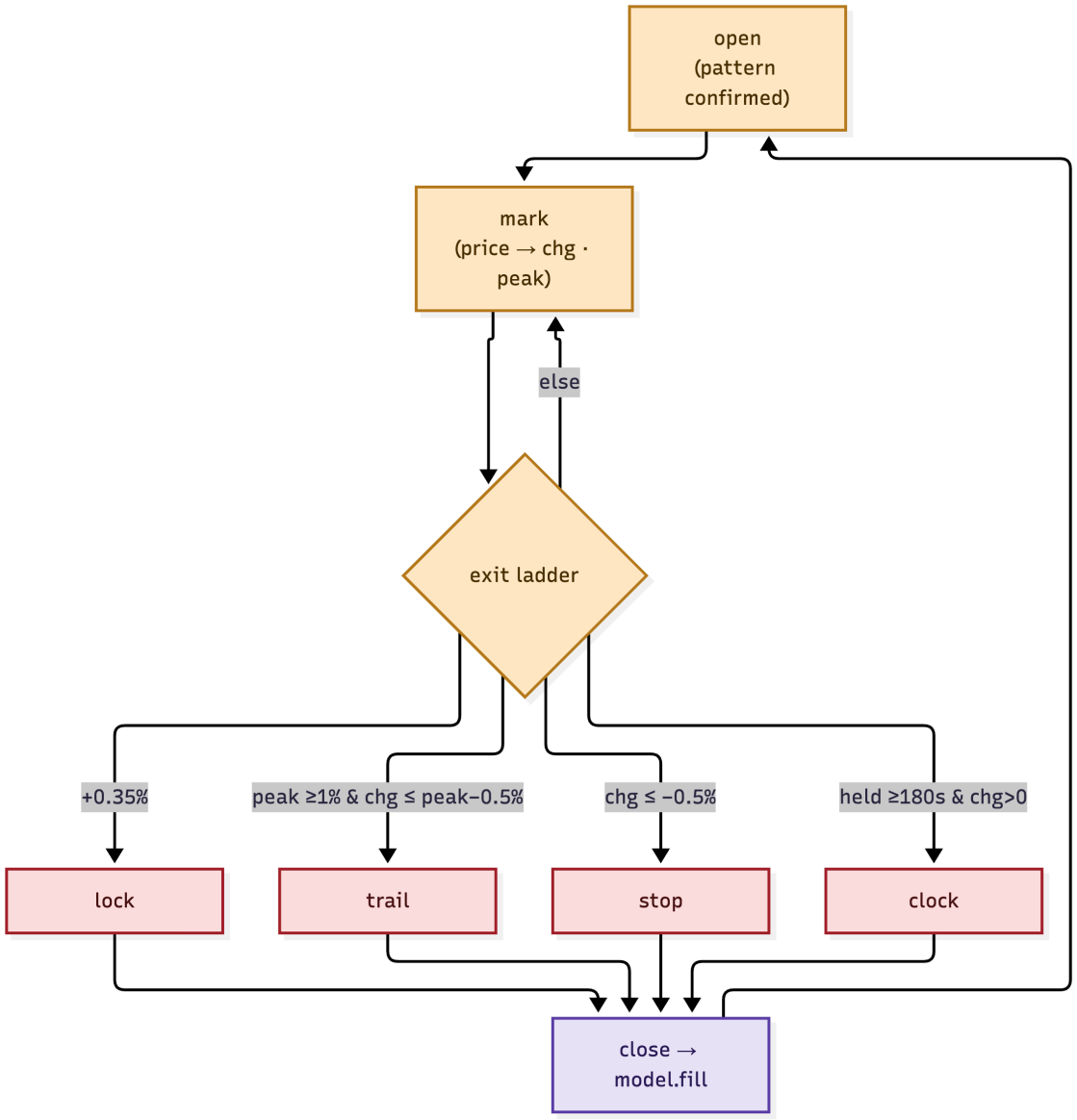


Figure 8.2 — open → mark → exit ladder → close → fill.

9. Pure Go — concurrency

The models and the engine run as **Go goroutines**, each decoupled from the others:

- **A slow model can't block the others** (each owns its goroutine).
- **A panicking model can't kill the pipeline** (panic is contained and reported).
- **Models run continuously**, publishing numbers whether or not anyone listens.

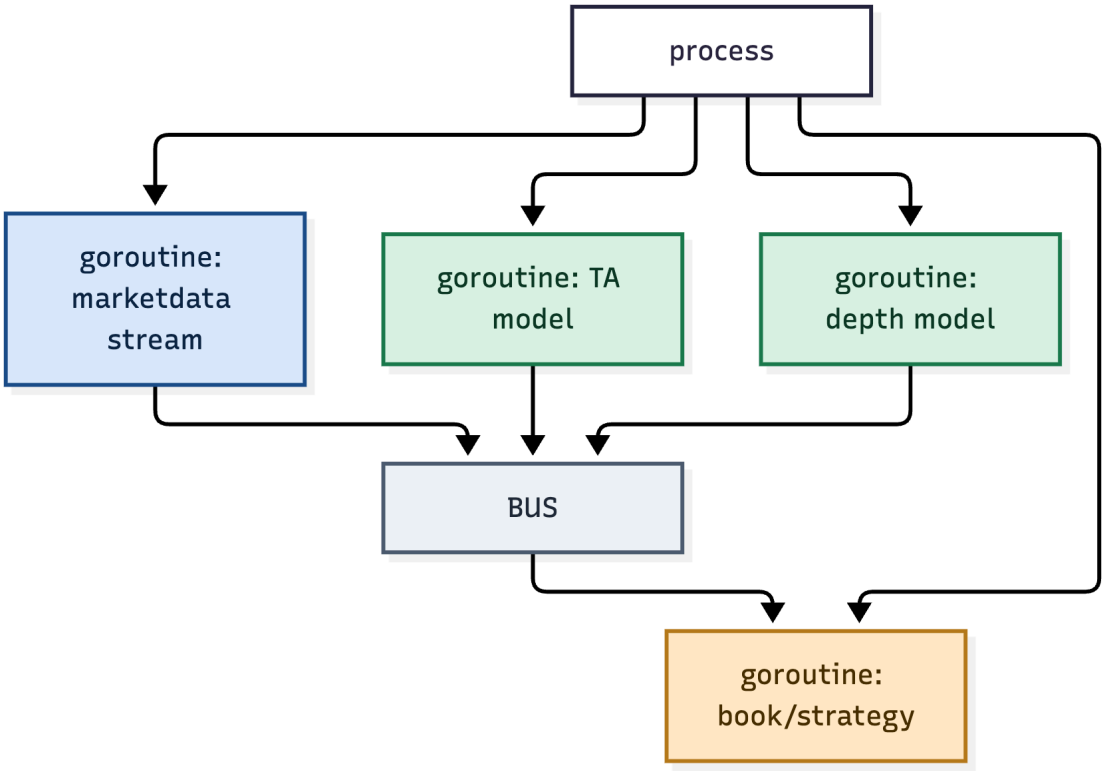


Figure 9.1 — the same independence the bus gives at the message level, goroutines give at the process level.

10. The full journey

One market tick's journey through the platform, end to end:

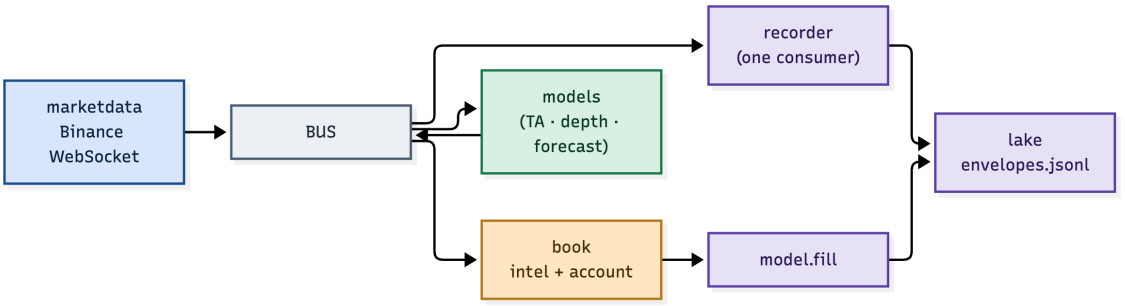


Figure 10.1 — data is recorded once and consumed many times; models publish, books decide.

Stage	What happens
1 · market data	Binance WebSocket → market.price / market.depth / market.candle
2 · the bus	every packet is an envelope with epoch ts and TTL
3 · recorder	the single consumer; writes the lake once
4 · models	subscribe, compute, publish model.decision
5 · book	accumulates the intel, confirms a pattern
6 · strategy	opens/closes, publishes model.fill
7 · lake	the fill is recorded, joining the same history

11. The envelope and pipeline

Covered in section 2 — reproduced here with the full field dictionary and the worked refusal path.

11.1 Reading a decision

A `model.decision` envelope carries the verdict, the confidence, and the reason. A refusal names the rule and the number that tripped it. The pipeline shows the interceptors that ran.

11.2 The refusal path

A refusal is not a log line — it is an envelope you can open:

```
model.decision NEARUSDT
  verdict   REFUSED
  reason    stale signals: 3230s old (max 90s)
  pipeline  authority pass · keying pass · correlation pass · freshness pass
  operator  alpha_rank · produced model.decision
  refs      market.candle 5007ms (derived) · market.depth 906ms (derived)
```

The freshness interceptor passed because the *envelope* was fresh; the refusal came from the model's own signal-age check — a distinction the record preserves.

12. The topic registry

The registry is the single source of truth for who may write what, and how long it lives.

Topic	Plane	Producers	Retention
`market.price`	market	market_data	drop
`market.depth`	market	market_data	drop
`market.candle`	market	market_data	drop
`market.mini24h`	market	market_data	drop
`ticks`	market	market_data	drop
`intel.signal`	intel	signals	60s
`intel.flow`	intel	signals	60s
`intel.movers`	intel	market_data, signals	60s
`intel.board`	intel	market_agent	60s
`intel.ta`	intel	tad	60s
`intel.forecast`	intel	forecast	60s
`alert.pumpdump`	alert	backend, signal_bus	300s
`model.decision`	model	models10, curve_rider, …	5m
`model.fill`	model	same	5m
`model.pnl`	model	same + supervisor	5m
`risk.state`	risk	risk	5m

Why TTL + no backlog: a market moves on the latest information; the bus is a state channel, not a job queue.

13. The risk governor

Between the tier signal and the trade sits the risk governor. It is the machine-enforced boundary that refuses a trade the models want but the account cannot afford.

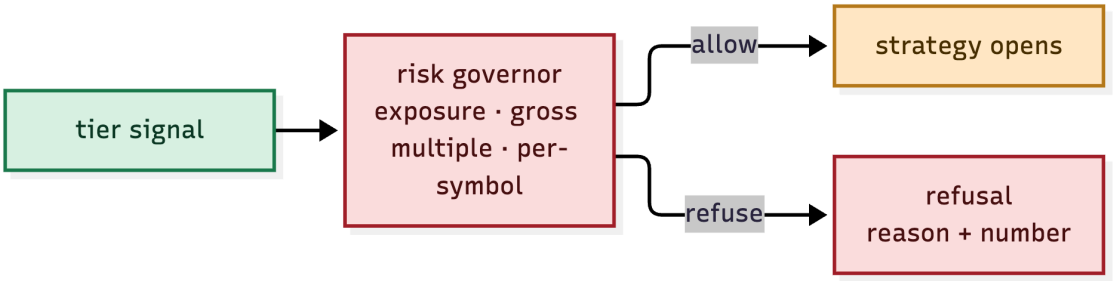


Figure 13.1 — every decision passes the exposure and gross-multiple checks before an order.

Check	What it refuses
exposure	a position above a fraction of the book
gross multiple	total notional beyond a leverage bound
per-symbol	concentration in one instrument
counter-trend	shorts into an up-regime (when disabled)

A refusal names the rule and the number, and is recorded — so "why not" is always answerable.

14. The evolution

Every step removed a coupling and added a layer of **memory** — which is exactly what a forecast needs.

Step	What changed
Monolithic script	models opened positions directly (coupled)
Streaming	depth + candles over WebSocket (never poll)
Pure Go	TA rules + book ported to Go (goroutines)
Decoupled bus	models publish model.decision over STOMP
Intel + patterns	book holds a signal window, confirms before trading
Continuous forecast	history + live + intel → tier signals

15. Model reference — the calculation agents in detail

Each model is a **pure function of its inputs**: candles (and, for the curve rider, the depth imbalance). It returns `buy`, `sell`, or nothing. It holds no state and knows nothing about accounts. That purity is what makes every model testable against generated data.

15.1 `donchian55` — range breakout

Question: is price breaking out of a 55-bar range?

```
hi = max(high[-55:]);  lo = min(low[-55:])
if hi == lo: return none
c = close[-1]
if c >= hi: return buy
if c <= lo: return sell
return none
```

Input	Lookback
55-bar high/low	55 candles
close	last candle

A breakout is the oldest and most persistent edge: a market that leaves its recent range tends to keep going. The `hi == lo` guard rejects a flat symbol, where no breakout is possible.

15.2 `orb` — opening range breakout

Question: is price breaking the first 15 minutes of the UTC day?

```
session = candles from today
if len(session) < 20: return none
hi = max(high of first 15);  lo = min(low of first 15)
if close > hi: return buy
if close < lo: return sell
```

Input	Lookback
first 15 candles of the day	session start
close	last candle

The opening range is where the day's conviction is established; breaking it is a genuine directional commitment rather than intraday noise.

15.3 `boll_squeeze` — volatility expansion

Question: is a tight Bollinger band starting to expand?

```
cl = close[-20:];  m = mean(cl);  sd = stdev(cl)
width = 2*sd/m
if close > m + 2*sd and width < 0.01: return buy
if close < m - 2*sd and width < 0.01: return sell
```

Input	Threshold
20-bar mean + stdev	width < 1% (squeeze)
close outside ±2σ	breakout

A squeeze (narrow band) precedes a move; the breakout direction is the signal. The width guard ensures the model only fires when the market was genuinely compressed.

15.4 `rsi2` — mean reversion at the extreme

Question: is the 2-bar RSI overbought or oversold?

```
r = rsi(close[-20:], period=2)
if r < 10: return buy
if r > 90: return sell
```

Input	Threshold
2-bar RSI	< 10 → buy; > 90 → sell

A very short RSI measures momentum exhaustion. The 2-bar period makes it respond in seconds, so it catches the exact moment a move is spent.

15.5 `vwap_revert` — mean reversion to volume

Question: is price stretched from its volume-weighted average?

```
vw = sum(close*vol over 30 bars) / sum(vol over 30 bars)
if close < vw * 0.994: return buy
if close > vw * 1.006: return sell
```

Input	Threshold
30-bar VWAP	±0.6% band

Price stretched 0.6% from VWAP is pulled back; the model fades the stretch.

15.6 `macd_trend` — momentum cross

Question: did the MACD histogram cross zero?

```
fast = ema(close, 12);  slow = ema(close, 26)
hist = fast - slow
prev = ema(close[:-1], 12) - ema(close[:-1], 26)
```

```
if prev <= 0 < hist: return buy
if prev >= 0 > hist: return sell
```

Input	Threshold
MACD(12,26) histogram	cross above/below zero

The zero cross is the moment short-term momentum overtakes the trend — a clean, binary turn signal.

15.7 `vol_break` — volume confirmation

Question: is volume spiking with a directional close?

```
avg = mean(volume[-20:-1])
if volume[-1] < 3*avg: return none
rng = high[-1] - low[-1]
if (close-low)/rng > 0.7: return buy
if (high-close)/rng > 0.7: return sell
```

Input	Threshold
volume vs 19-bar average	> 3×
close in the bar's range	top/bottom 30%

A volume spike that closes near the extreme of the bar is participation with conviction — the difference between a move and a wiggle.

15.8 `ema_pullback` — trend continuation

Question: is price pulling back to the EMA trend and holding?

```
e20 = ema(close, 20);  e50 = ema(close, 50)
if e20 > e50 and close > e50 and |close-e20|/e20 < 0.002: return buy
if e20 < e50 and close < e50 and |close-e20|/e20 < 0.002: return sell
```

Input	Threshold
EMA20 vs EMA50	trend
close vs EMA20	within 0.2%

A pullback to a rising EMA that holds is the classic continuation entry — with the trend, at a discount.

15.9 `atr_channel` — volatility channel breakout

Question: is price outside an ATR-based channel?

```
m = ema(close, 20);  a = atr(14)
if close > m + 1.5*a: return buy
if close < m - 1.5*a: return sell
```

Input	Threshold
EMA20 ± 1.5×ATR	channel

The channel adapts to volatility: in a quiet market the channel is tight, in a wild one it is wide, so "outside the channel" always means a real move.

15.10 `curve_rider` — order-flow imbalance

Question: which market has the strongest book imbalance, and which way?

```
imb = (bid_volume − ask_volume) / (bid_volume + ask_volume)
if |imb| > 0.3:
    side = buy if imb > 0 else sell
```

Input	Threshold
depth5 bid/ask volume	|imb| > 0.3
price	best bid/ask midpoint

The order book is what the market is *thinking* right now — heavier bids mean real buying pressure, heavier asks real selling. The curve rider enters the strongest and rides it with the trail.

16. Worked examples

16.1 A bull run — how the streak becomes a tier signal

During a sustained up-move, a single `donchian55` buy signal is not enough. The book records each signal in its rolling window:

Time	Signal	Window state	Decision
t0	buy	[buy]	wait — 1 signal
t1	buy	[buy, buy]	wait — 2 signals
t2	buy	[buy, buy, buy]	**pattern confirmed → tier signal**

The model was *not sure* at t0 and t1; at t2 the streak made it confident. The strategy opens, and the `trail` exit lets the position run while the streak holds — the bull run is ridden, not skimmed at the first tick.

16.2 A refusal — why the model did nothing

A model presents a decision, but the risk governor refuses it:

```
model.decision SOXLUSDT  side=buy  confidence=0.71
  governor   REFUSED  gross multiple 12.4× > limit 8×
```

The refusal names the rule and the number. Nothing is silent: the refusal is recorded as an envelope, and the WHY view lists it with the exact reason. The system did not fail to trade — it correctly refused a trade the account could not afford.

16.3 A full trade — entry to fill

```
t0  pattern confirmed (3 × donchian55 buy)          → strategy opens 2500 notional
t1  mark +0.41%  → lock (≥ +0.35%)                  → close, net +0.21%
    → publish model.fill {reason: lock, net_pct: 0.21}
t2  the fill joins the lake, correlated to the decision
```

The whole chain — decision → fill → pnl — is linked by one correlation id, so any trade can be traced from the market tick that triggered it to the fill it produced.

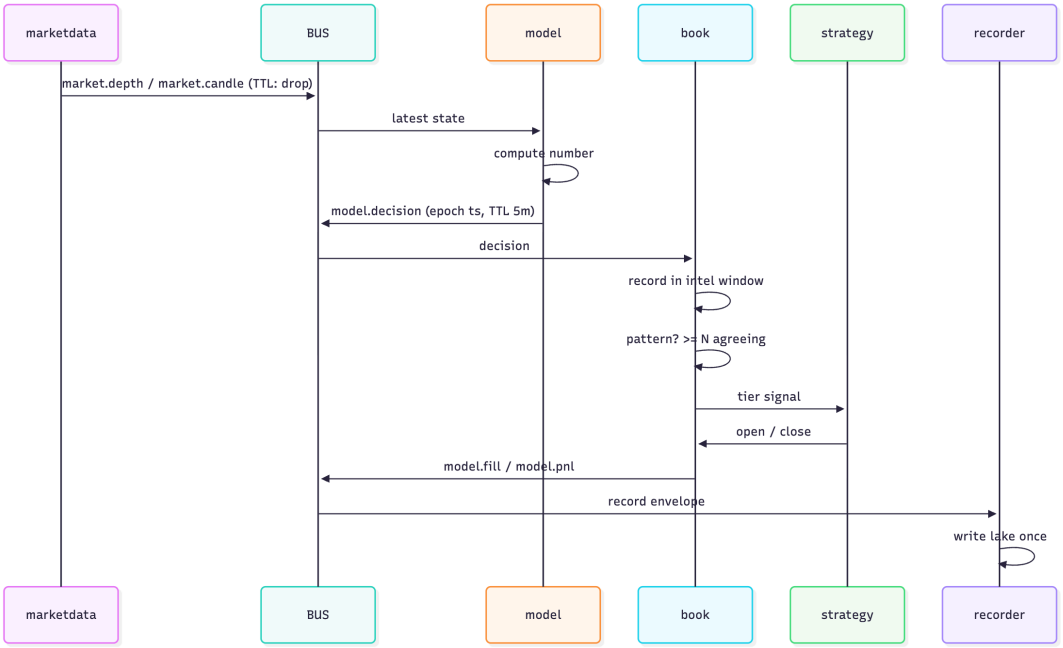


Figure 16.1 — marketdata → bus → model → book → strategy → recorder, one tick's journey.

17. Data signals — deep dive

17.1 Depth imbalance — what the book is thinking

The order book is a live vote. Bid volume is money wanting to buy; ask volume is money wanting to sell. The imbalance is the net of the two, normalised:

```
imbalance = (bid_volume − ask_volume) / (bid_volume + ask_volume)
```

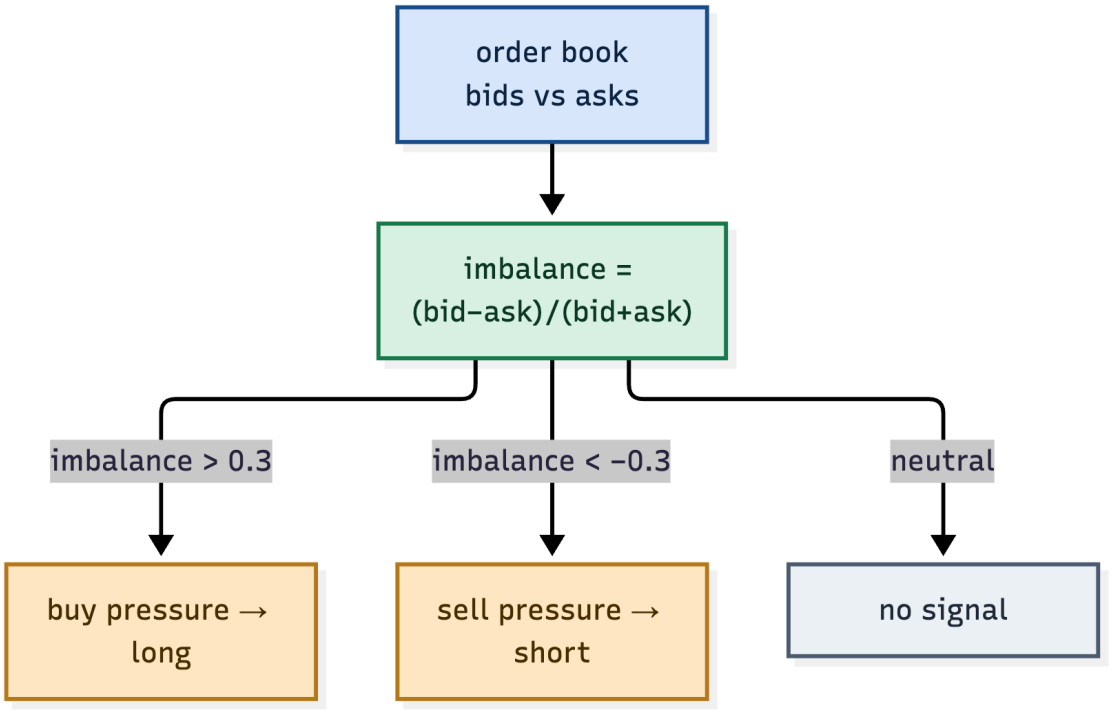


Figure 17.1 — heavier bids → long; heavier asks → short; balanced → no signal.

imbalance	Reading	Action
> +0.3	buy pressure	consider long
< −0.3	sell pressure	consider short
near 0	balanced	no signal

The book is what the market is *thinking right now* — it leads price, because it shows the orders already resting that will move the market next.

17.2 Open interest — new money entering

Open interest is the number of open contracts. A change in OI over an interval tells you whether a move is backed by *new* positions (conviction) or just unwinding (exhaustion).

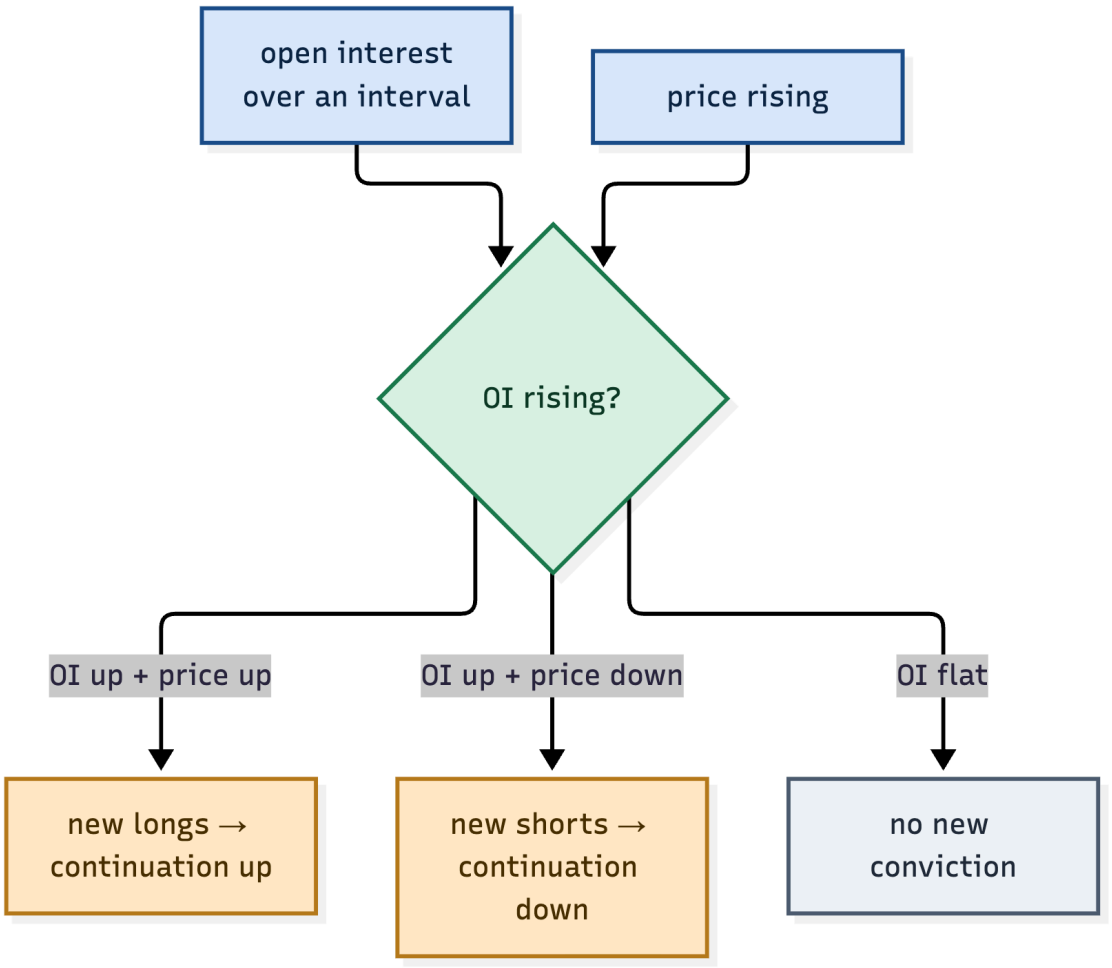


Figure 17.2 — OI rising with price = new longs; OI rising against price = new shorts.

OI	Price	Reading
rising	rising	new longs — continuation up
rising	falling	new shorts — continuation down
flat	either	no new conviction

17.3 Volume — participation and conviction

Volume is participation. A price move on high volume is conviction; the same move on thin volume is noise. The spike rule catches the difference:

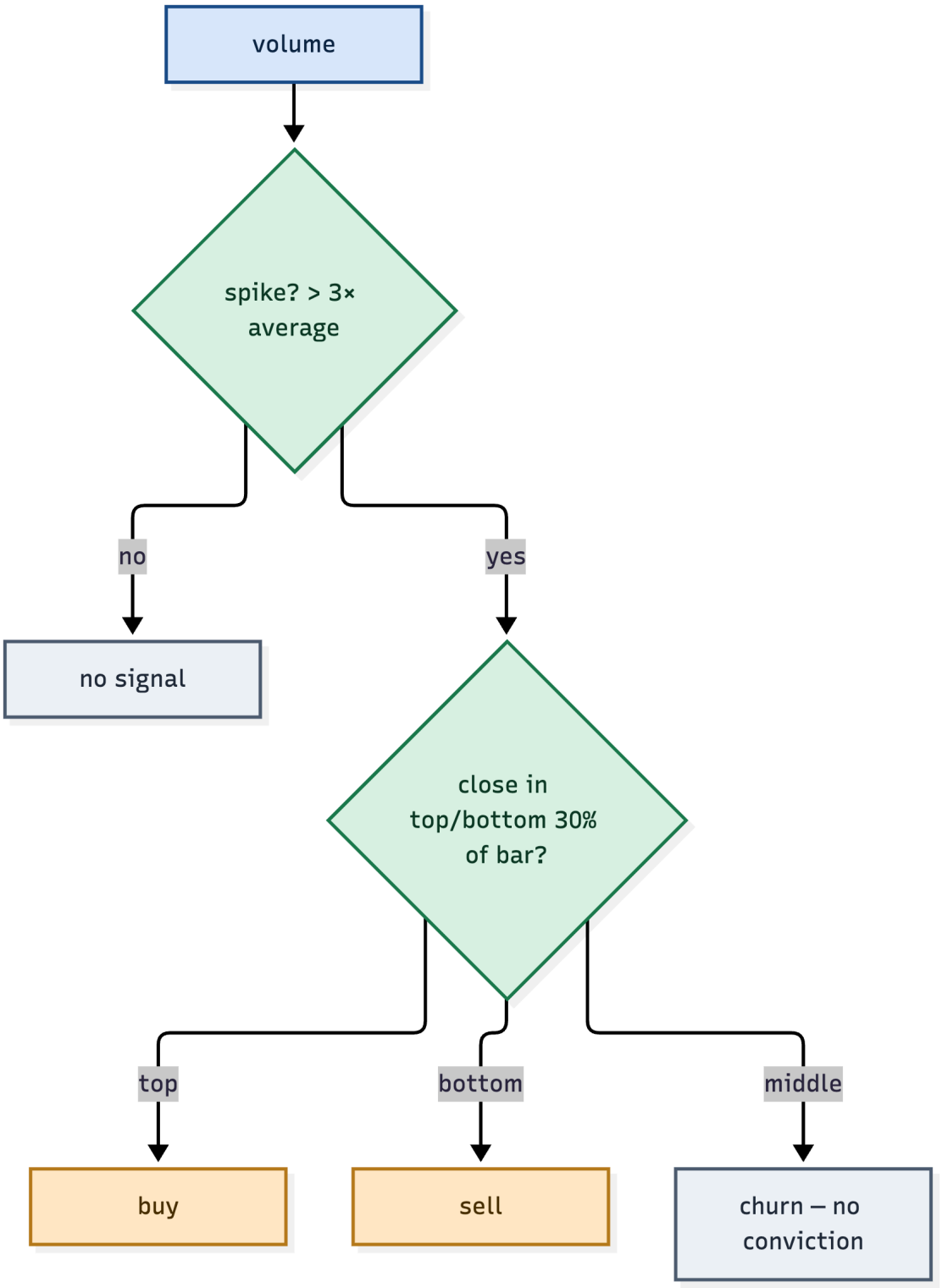


Figure 17.3 — a spike with a directional close is conviction; a spike with a middle close is churn.

Volume	Close position in bar	Reading

> 3× average	top 30%	buy
> 3× average	bottom 30%	sell
> 3× average	middle	churn — no conviction
normal	any	no signal

18. Correlation and lineage

Every piece of work is followed by one **correlation id**. A market tick leads to a decision, the decision to a fill, the fill to a pnl update — all carrying the same cid, so the whole chain is resolvable in the lake.

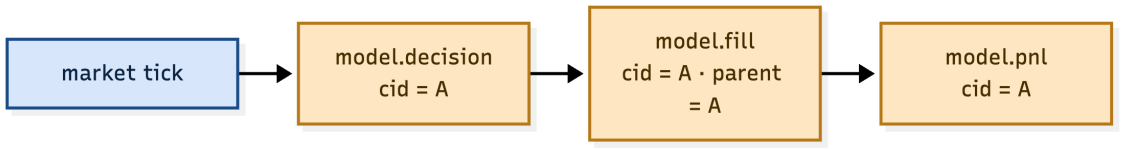


Figure 18.1 — tick → decision → fill → pnl, all keyed to correlation id A.

The lineage is what turns the platform into evidence: any trade can be traced from the raw market packet that triggered it to the fill it produced, with no interpretation required.

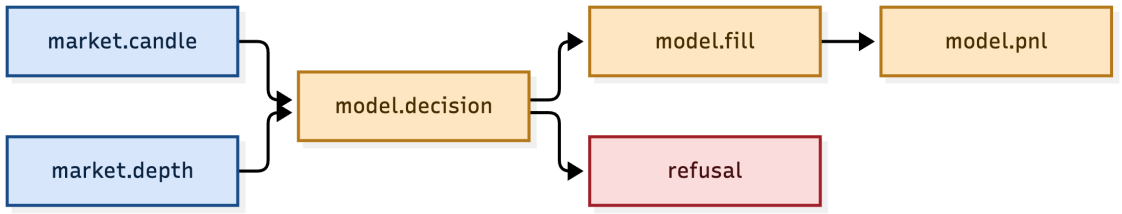


Figure 18.2 — market data → decision → (fill | refusal) → pnl.

18.1 Declared vs derived references

A reference is **declared** when the producer names its inputs; it is **derived** when the recorder infers them (the newest envelope of each input topic for that symbol in the window, marked with its age). The record always says which — a derived reference is never silently presented as declared.

19. Book states

The book is a small state machine. Every position moves through the same states, and the exit ladder is the only thing that moves it forward.

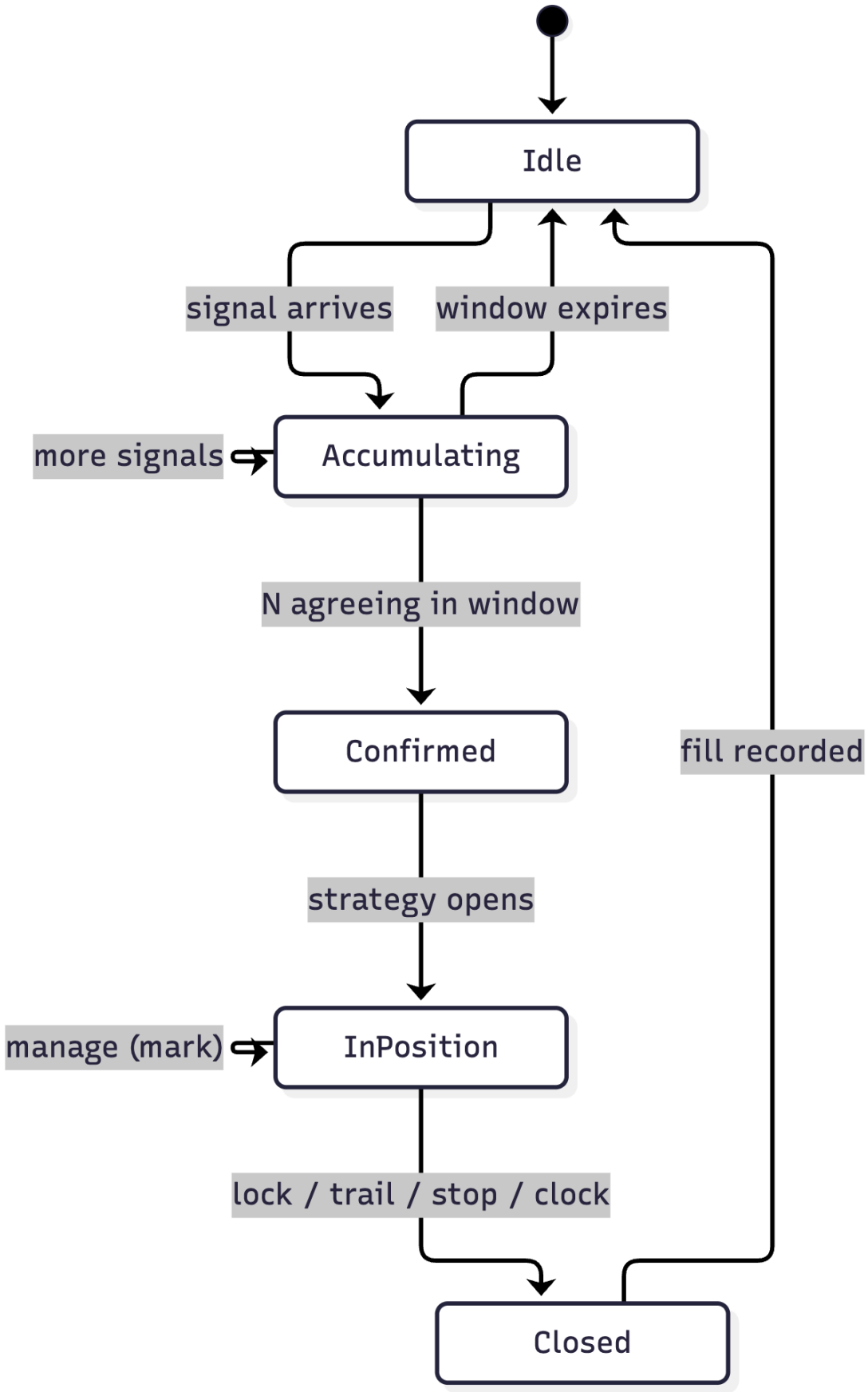

Idle
signal arrives
window expires
more signals
Accumulating
N agreeing in window
Confirmed
fill recorded
strategy opens
manage (mark)
InPosition
lock / trail / stop / clock
Closed

Figure 19.1 — idle → accumulating → confirmed → in position → closed → idle.

State	Meaning
`Idle`	no position, waiting for a signal
`Accumulating`	signals arriving, pattern not yet confirmed
`Confirmed`	N agreeing signals in the window
`InPosition`	a position is open, being marked
`Closed`	the position closed, fill recorded

The window expiring returns `Accumulating` to `Idle` — old signals are dropped, so a pattern never forms from stale intel.

20. The recorder and the lake

The bus has **one consumer**: the recorder. It writes every envelope **once** into the lake, then fans it out to readers (the explorer, the dashboards). This single-writer design is why the record is append-only and auditable.

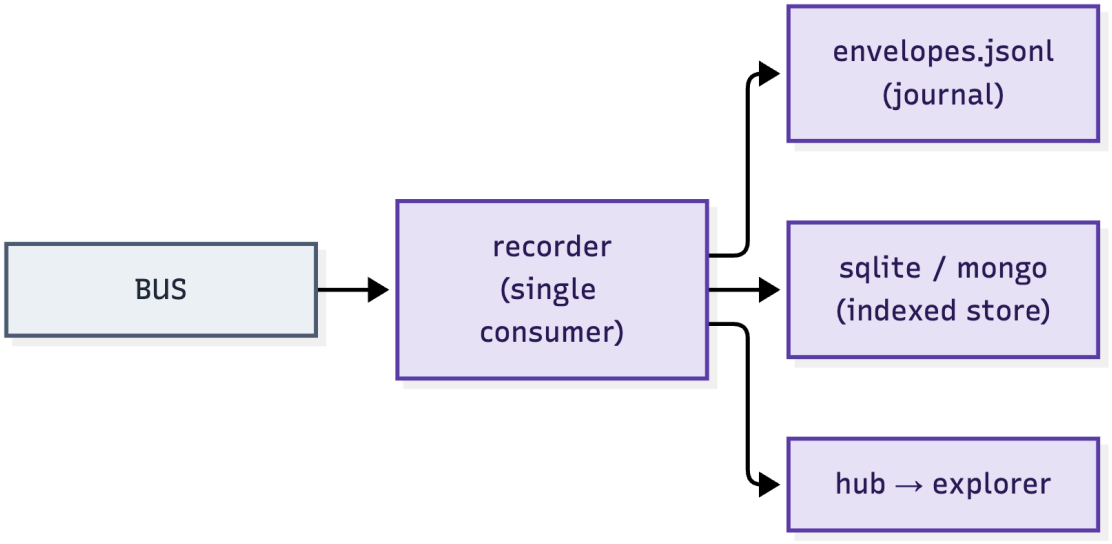


Figure 20.1 — bus → recorder → journal + indexed store → explorer.

Store	What it holds
`envelopes.jsonl`	the append-only journal
sqlite / mongo	the indexed, queryable copy
hub	fans envelopes to readers

21. The supervisor and control plane

The supervisor is the orchestrator: it launches and restarts the models, watches health, and publishes the aggregate pnl. It never trades — it only keeps the trading processes alive and honest.

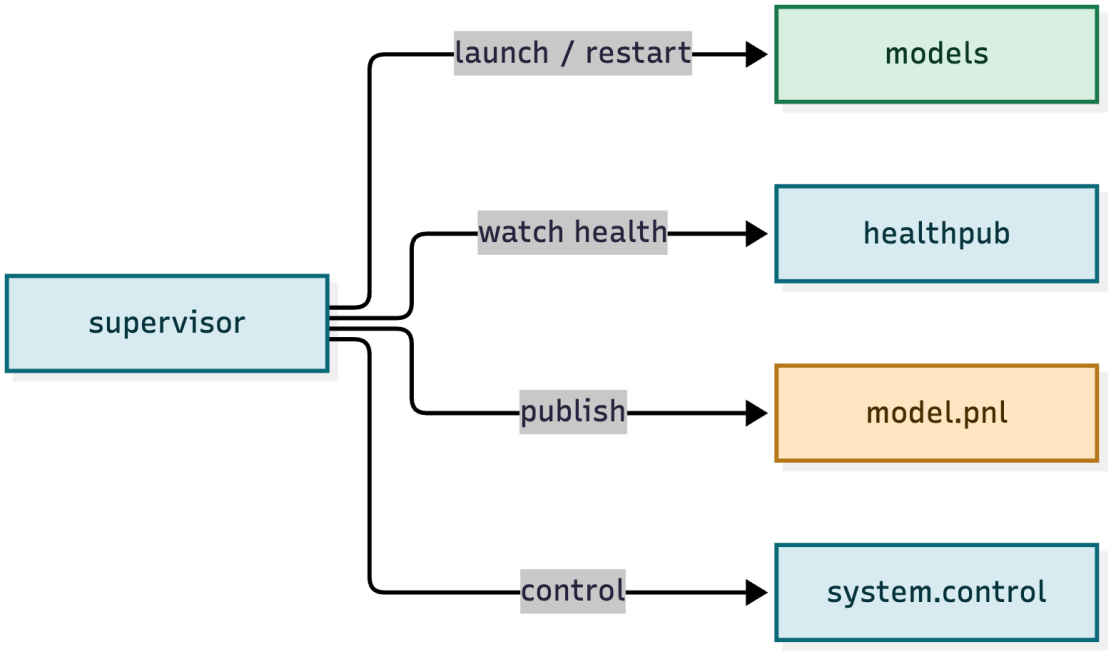


Figure 21.1 — launch/restart models, watch health, publish pnl, accept control.

Duty	Topic / action
launch + restart models	process supervision
watch health	`system.health`
publish aggregate pnl	`model.pnl`
accept commands	`system.control`

22. Example trades — each exit, worked

22.1 The stop

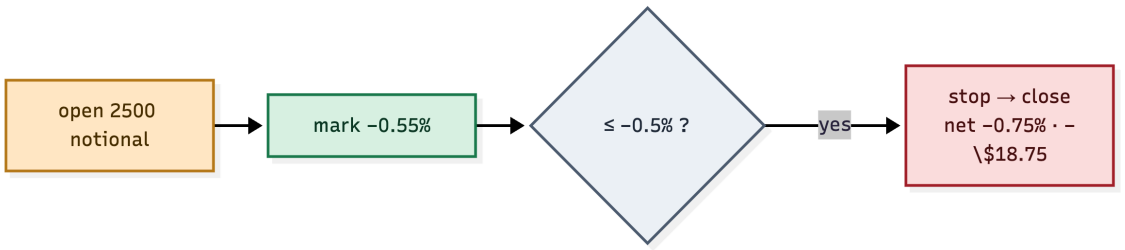


Figure 22.1 — a −0.55% mark trips the −0.5% stop, capping the loss.

The stop is the non-negotiable floor. On 2,500 notional, a −0.5% gross move is −0.7% net after fees — a loss of about $18. The point of the stop is not that it is small, but that it is *bounded*: no position is allowed to bleed beyond it.

22.2 The trail

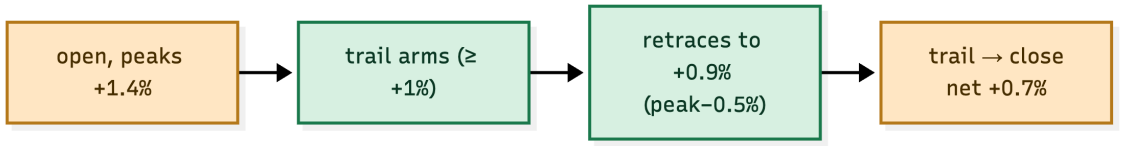


Figure 22.2 — the position peaks +1.4%, arms the trail, and exits on a −0.5% pullback at +0.9%.

The trail is how a winner is ridden: once the peak clears +1%, the exit follows the price down, so the position stays in while the move holds and exits only when it genuinely turns.

22.3 The cascade rebound

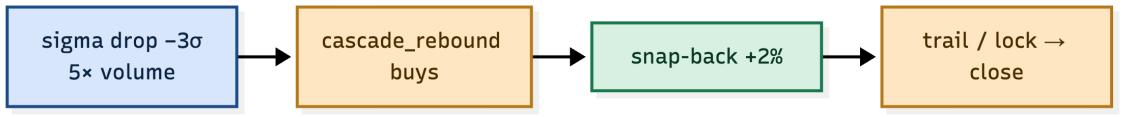


Figure 22.3 — a −3σ drop on 5× volume is bought, and the snap-back is ridden.

The cascade model buys the liquidation flush — the sharpest, most frightened sellers — and rides the reflexive bounce.

22.4 The funding carry

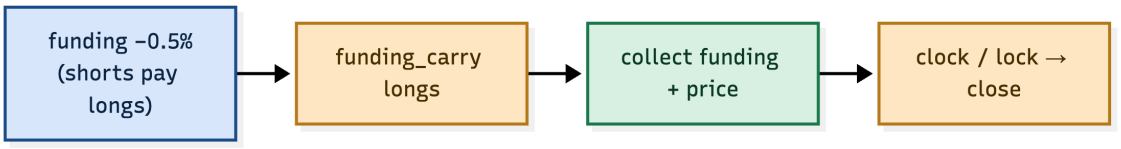


Figure 22.4 — negative funding means shorts pay longs; the book longs and collects.

When funding is deeply negative, shorts are paying longs to hold. The book goes long those perps, collects the funding, and exits on the clock or the lock.

23. Risk accounting

The governor measures the account as a whole, not trade by trade. The binding number is the **gross multiple**: total notional divided by equity.

```
gross multiple = Σ notional / equity
```

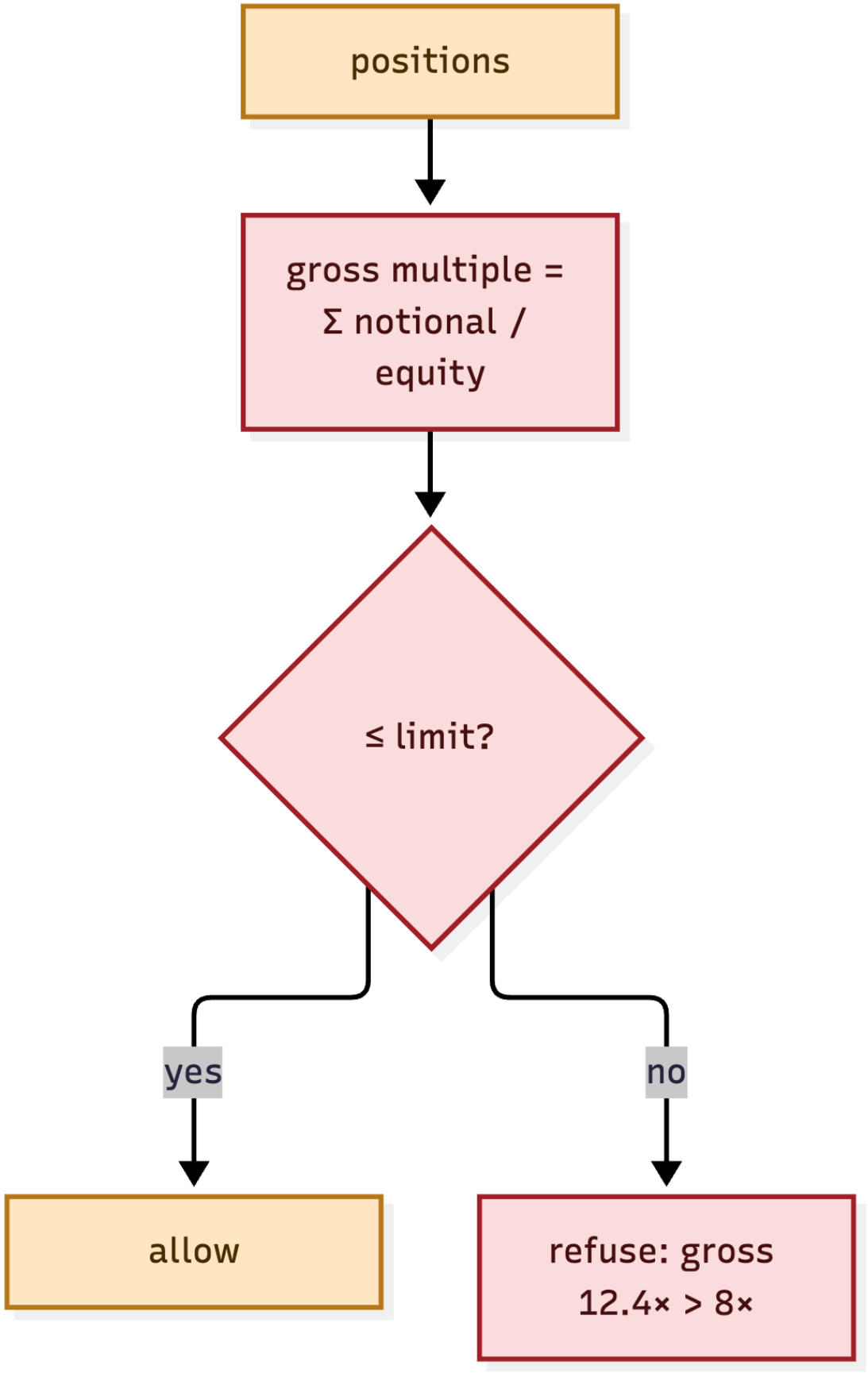

positions
gross multiple = Σ notional / equity
≤ limit?
yes
no
allow
refuse: gross 12.4× > 8×

Figure 23.1 — total exposure is measured against equity, and refused past the limit.

Check	Refuses when
gross multiple	total notional exceeds the leverage bound
exposure	one position is too large a fraction of the book
per-symbol	one instrument is over-concentrated

The refusal names the rule and the number — `gross 12.4× > 8×` — so the bound is never a vague feeling but a recorded, auditable decision.

24. The envelope journey, restated

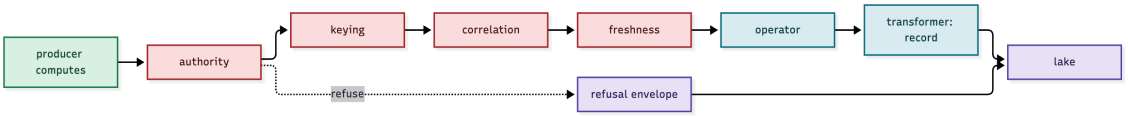


Figure 24.1 — authority, keying, correlation, freshness, then the operator, then the transformer.

A refusal at any interceptor is itself recorded as an envelope, so the record contains both the trades *and* the reasons for non-trades.

25. Tier decisions, restated

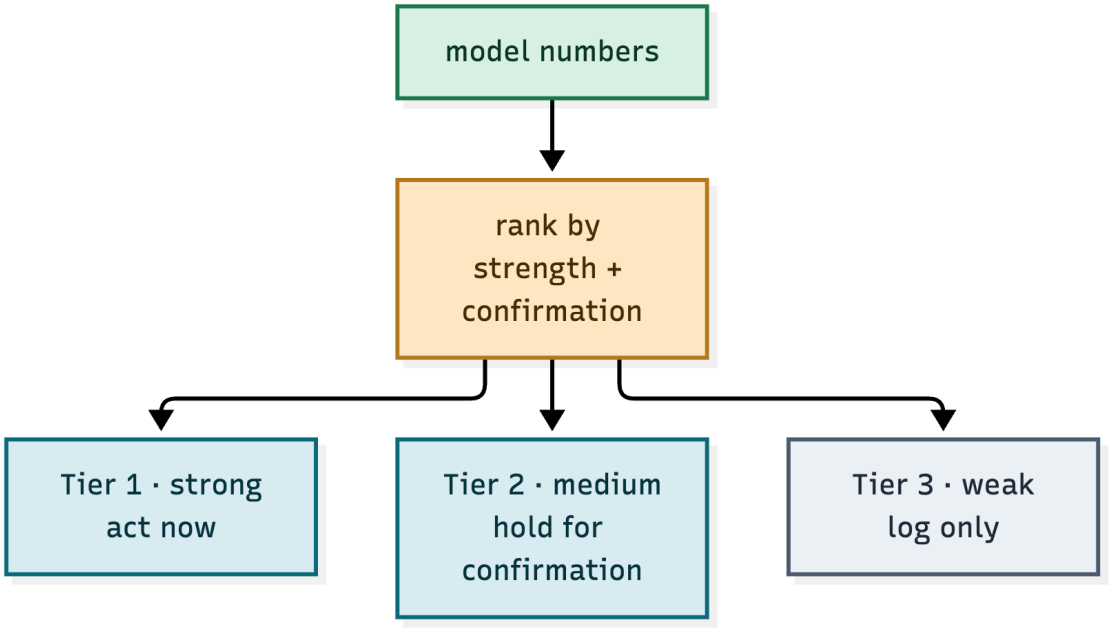


Figure 25.1 — strength + confirmation decide the tier, and the tier decides the action.

The tier system is what prevents the strategy from treating every number as equal: a strong confirmed signal acts immediately, a weak one is ignored. That ranking is the difference between a forecast and a firehose.

26. Design decisions — why it is built this way

Every choice is a decision with a consequence. These are the reasons, stated plainly.

26.1 Why the bus and not direct calls

Decision	Reason	Consequence
models publish numbers	a model must not know who listens	any consumer can use any model's output
envelopes with TTL	the market moves on the latest state	stale packets evaporate; no backlog
a single topic registry	one source of truth for who may write what	a producer contract is one line
correlation ids	follow the work across components	any trade is traceable end to end

The alternative — a model calling a book directly — is faster to write and impossible to reason about. The bus trades a little latency for complete observability.

26.2 Why the book holds the intel

A model that acts on one signal is a coin flip. The same model that waits for a *streak* is a forecast. The book's rolling window is the memory that turns the former into the latter.

Without the window	With the window
one signal → trade	N agreeing signals → trade
noise is traded	noise is filtered
the model is a blip detector	the model is a pattern detector

26.3 Why TTL and no backlog

A queued message is a stale message. If a slow subscriber read a queue, it would act on data that is minutes old. With TTL, the bus is a **state channel**: a subscriber reads the current picture or nothing. The freshness interceptor enforces the same idea per-envelope.

26.4 Why the exit ladder is fixed

A fixed ladder is a *risk envelope*, not a strategy. It says: profit is banked at +0.35%, loss is capped at −0.5%, winners are ridden, and nothing is held forever. The ladder does not predict the market — it ensures that whatever the market does, the outcome is bounded and the winners have room to run.

26.5 Why the models are pure

A pure function of candles + depth is testable against generated data — no network, no clock, no state. That is what the model test harness relies on: every rule is a function, so every rule can be verified with synthetic bars before it ever sees a live market.

27. The forecast — how the layers combine

The forecast is not one number. It is a function of three layers:

```
forecast = f( live · historical · signal intel )
```

Layer	Contribution	Weight in the decision
live	direction of pressure now	the *trigger*
historical	where price is in its range	the *context*
signal intel	whether a pattern is forming	the *confidence*

27.1 The trigger — live

The live layer answers "what is happening now": the depth imbalance, the last price, the volume spike. It is the fastest and the noisiest, which is why it alone is never enough.

27.2 The context — historical

The historical layer answers "where are we": 200 bars of OHLCV tell the model whether price is breaking out of a range (donchian), stretched from VWAP, or at the top of a channel. It turns a raw move into a *position within a range*.

27.3 The confidence — signal intel

The intel layer answers "is this real": the recent signal history. Three agreeing signals in the window raise confidence from a blip to a pattern. This is the layer that prevents the system from trading every tick.

27.4 Worked combination

```
live:      SOXLUSDT imbalance +0.41  (buy pressure)
historical: close breaks the 55-bar high (donchian55 → buy)
intel:     three donchian55 buy signals in 90s  (pattern confirmed)

forecast = strong long → tier 1 → strategy opens
```

Each layer on its own would have been a weak or premature signal; combined they are a conviction the strategy can act on.

28. The Go code structure

The models and the engine run as Go binaries, split by module.

Module	Path	What it holds
`backend`	`backend/`	the market client, the flow engine, the detectors
`core`	`scalp5/core/`	the bus (stomp, topics, envelope), marketdata, recorder
`scalp`	`backend/cmd/scalp/`	the TA rules + book + stream feed (pure Go)
`scalp-bus`	`scalp5/core/cmd/scalp/`	the bus-decoupled models + engine

28.1 The `scalp-bus` binary — one process, four goroutines

```
main
 ├─ goroutine: marketdata subscription (market.candle / market.depth)
 ├─ goroutine: TA model publisher  (9 rules → model.decision)
 ├─ goroutine: depth model publisher (imbalance → model.decision)
 └─ goroutine: engine (subscribe model.decision → book → model.fill)
```

Each goroutine is independent: a slow one cannot block the others, a panic is contained, and each runs whether or not any other does. This is the runtime mirror of the bus.

28.2 The exit ladder in Go

The manage loop evaluates the four exits in order on every mark:

```
switch {
case chg >= +0.35:                    reason = "lock"
case peak >= +1.0 && chg <= peak-0.5:  reason = "trail"
case chg <= -0.5:                      reason = "stop"
case held >= 180 && chg > 0:           reason = "clock"
}
```

The order matters: profit is banked before the trail can give it back, the trail rides before the stop can cut a winner, and the stop caps any loser before the clock can let it run.

29. More worked examples

29.1 A churn day — why nothing traded

Volume spikes but closes in the middle of the bar; RSI stays between 10 and 90; no range is broken. The models publish signals, but none confirm a pattern, and the book stays in `Accumulating` until the window expires.

The record shows this honestly: the WHY view lists the near-misses with their reasons, and the book's trade count is zero *for a reason* — not because the system broke, but because the market gave no confirmable pattern.

29.2 A mean-reversion trade

```
vwap_revert:  price 0.5% below VWAP → sell-side stretch → buy signal
rsi2:         RSI 8 (oversold)      → buy signal
pattern:      two agreeing buy signals in the window → confirmed
strategy:     open long, exit on lock at +0.35%
```

Two independent models agreeing on the same side is the *streak* — the confirmation that turns two weak signals into one strong tier signal.

29.3 A generation gap — detecting a silent producer

The recorder sees `model.decision` generation jump from 105 to 108. Three messages are missing. The gap is a fact, not a rounding error: a producer dropped three packets, or was silent for three cycles. The envelope's `generation` field is exactly what makes this detectable.

29.4 A full session, end to end

```
09:00  marketdata connects, depth + candles flow
09:01  models backfill 200 × 1m bars
09:02  donchian55 fires on SOLUSDT → model.decision
09:02  book records the signal in the window (1/3)
09:04  two more agree (3/3) → pattern confirmed → tier 1
09:04  strategy opens 2,500 notional
09:05  mark +0.41% → lock → close net +0.21% → model.fill
09:05  fill joins the lake, correlated to the decision
```

Every step is an envelope with an epoch timestamp, so the whole session can be replayed from the lake — which is the point of recording once and reading many times.

30. Operations and monitoring

30.1 What must be running

Service	Port	Purpose
market data	8796	the source of price, depth and candle envelopes
recorder	8801	consumes the bus once and writes the lake
envelope explorer	8802	the viewer for every recorded envelope
the bus	61613	STOMP broker
scalp (models + engine)	—	publishes decisions, trades

Start them in order: broker, market data, recorder, then the models and the explorer. If the explorer comes up first it will simply be empty until the recorder starts.

30.2 Health checks

Check	How	Expected
feed alive	GET :8796/health	prices > 0, kline series rising
recorder consuming	GET :8801/stats	received = written, errors 0
bus bound	queue q.rec.model.decision	consumers 1, publish rising
a model is silent	producer generation	no gap between consecutive envelopes

A generation gap is a fact: if `model.decision` jumps from 105 to 108, three packets were lost or the producer was silent for three cycles. The gap is detectable *because* the envelope carries a monotonic generation.

30.3 Restarting

Restart order matters. The explorer reads the lake the recorder writes; the models read the market data. Stop in reverse, start in order, and the record is never broken — the lake is append-only, so a restart never rewrites history.

31. Testing the models

Every model is a **pure function of its inputs**, so every model is testable against generated data — no network, no clock, no state. This is what the test harness relies on.

31.1 The harness

Suite	What it verifies
`test_engine_book_models`	the book: open, mark, the exit ladder, the floor
`test_signal_scenarios`	each rule's signal against synthetic bars
`test_realistic_scenarios`	realistic price paths
`test_crazy_market`	a 192-row stress sweep — extreme moves
`table_results`	the expected-vs-actual result table

The rule: a behaviour fix ships its regression test in the same commit. A fix without a test is half-work.

31.2 Why generated data

A test that reads the live market is not a test — it is a bet on whatever the market happens to be doing. Generated data lets the same input be asserted every time: a 10× volume burst must read as a 10× burst, a −3σ drop must read as a cascade, a range breakout must read as a breakout. Deterministic inputs, deterministic assertions.

32. Appendix — the complete topic registry

Topic	Plane	Producers	Retention
`market.price`	market	market_data	drop
`market.candle`	market	market_data	drop
`market.depth`	market	market_data	drop
`market.mini24h`	market	market_data	drop
`ticks`	market	market_data	drop
`intel.signal`	intel	signals	60s
`intel.flow`	intel	signals	60s
`intel.movers`	intel	market_data, signals	60s
`intel.board`	intel	market_agent	60s
`intel.ta`	intel	tad	60s
`intel.forecast`	intel	forecast	60s
`alert.pumpdump`	alert	backend, signal_bus	300s
`model.decision`	model	models10, curve_rider, …	5m
`model.fill`	model	same	5m
`model.pnl`	model	same + supervisor	5m
`model.rank`	model	alpha_rank	5m
`model.evaluate`	model	tad	60s
`risk.state`	risk	risk	5m
`review.verdict`	review	portfolio_review	5m
`exec.quote`	exec	maker	60s
`system.health`	system	healthpub, master	10m
`system.control`	system	master, supervisor, cli	1d

32.1 Reading the retention column

- **drop** — live only; a subscriber must be connected to see it (no backlog, by design).
- **60s / 5m / 10m** — kept for that window so a late subscriber can catch up on state.
- **1d** — control messages persist longest, because a command must survive a slow consumer.

33. Glossary, expanded

Term	Meaning
envelope	the fixed carrier: data, meta, references
plane	the traffic class: market, intel, model, risk, control, system
topic	the channel an envelope is published on
producer	the component that computed a payload
generation	a producer's monotonic counter; a gap means loss
correlation id	the identity that follows one piece of work
reference	a link to an input envelope, declared or derived
interceptor	a rule that runs before work and can refuse
operator	the capability that produces a payload
transformer	a stage that changes an envelope's shape
hop	one recorded pipeline stage
refusal	a decision the governor declined, with the rule named
tier signal	a strength-ranked, pattern-confirmed decision
intel window	the book's bounded rolling signal history
imbalance	bid volume minus ask volume, normalised
gross multiple	total notional divided by equity
lake	the recorded store of envelopes
streak	several agreeing signals inside the window
forecast	f(live · historical · signal intel)

34. Summary

The system is a **decoupled streaming forecast**: market data streams in (never polled), the models publish numbers (never trading directly), the bus carries them as stamped envelopes (never backlogged), the books accumulate the intel (never too much), and the strategies trade only on confirmed patterns (never on a lone blip).

- **A model alone is an opinion; a book with history is a conviction.**
- **Data alone is noise; data + context + memory is a forecast.**
- **The bus keeps it decoupled and real-time; TTL keeps it fresh; the window keeps it informed.**

That is the architecture, and every diagram in this document is one view of the same principle: **combined, historical, and continuously updated — so it can forecast, and fire a tier signal worth trading.**

Appendix D — the payloads, verbatim

A `market.depth` packet:

```
{"symbol":"BTCUSDT","bids":[{"p":81777.5,"q":2.13}],
 "asks":[{"p":81778.0,"q":19.9}],
 "bid_qty":2.13,"ask_qty":19.9,"imbalance":-0.81,"ts":1792741261000}
```

A `model.decision` packet:

```
{"symbol":"SOLUSDT","side":"buy","model":"donchian55",
 "score":1.0,"ts_ms":1792741261000,"why":"close >= 55-bar high"}
```

A `model.fill` packet:

```
{"model":"donchian55","symbol":"SOLUSDT","side":"buy",
 "reason":"lock","net_pct":0.21,"pnl_usd":5.25,"ts_ms":1792741267000}
```

Each is a small, self-describing number — the exact kind of packet the bus was designed to carry, and the exact kind of evidence the lake preserves.

Appendix E — the planes, their purpose and their producers

Plane	Purpose	Example producers
`market`	raw exchange data, live only	market_data
`intel`	derived intelligence	signals, tad, forecast
`model`	decisions and outcomes	models10, curve_rider, alpha_rank
`risk`	the governor's state and refusals	risk
`review`	portfolio verdicts	portfolio_review
`exec`	execution quotes	maker
`control`	orchestration and commands	supervisor, master

`system`	health and control	healthpub, master

The plane is the first thing any reader checks: it tells you *what class of traffic* a packet is before you read its payload — market data, a model's opinion, or the governor's decision. Together with the topic, the plane is the address; the envelope is the letter.

Appendix F — THE X FILES

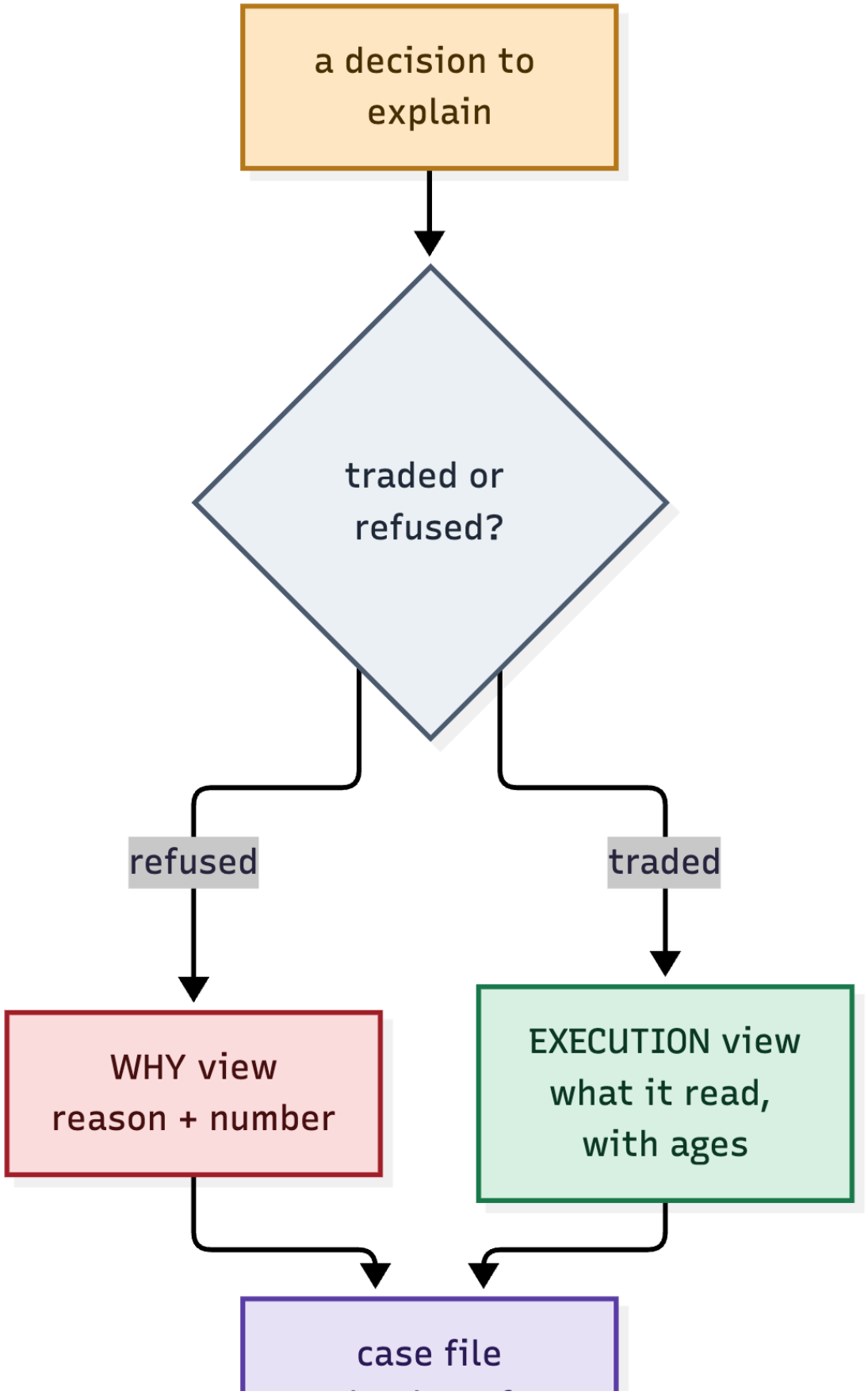
> *"The truth is out there." In this system, the truth is **in the envelopes**. Every decision, every trade, every refusal is a stamped packet in an append-only lake — so any question an investigator can ask, the record can answer. This appendix is the field manual: how to **debug a decision**, how to **optimise a model**, and how the **absolute traceability** of the platform works. It is the most satisfying part of the whole design.*

F.1 The investigation mindset

When a model traded — or did not — the first question is never "is it a bug". It is:

1. **What did it read?** — the references, with their ages at execution.
2. **What did it decide?** — the verdict, the confidence, the reason.
3. **What stopped it?** — the refusal, with the rule and the number.

The system records all three for every decision, so the investigation is a *read*, not a *guess*. There is no "it probably did X" — there is only the envelope that says what it did.


a decision to explain
traded or refused?
refused
traded
WHY view reason + number
EXECUTION view what it read, with ages
case file

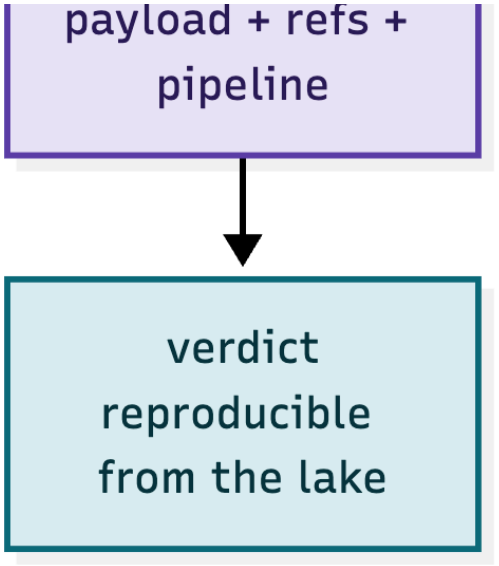


Figure F.1 — every decision resolves to a verdict you can reproduce from the lake.

F.2 Debugging a decision

F.2.1 Traded or refused?

The first fork: did the decision become a trade, or a refusal? The answer decides which view to open.

- **Refused** → the WHY view, which ranks refusals by rule and shows the exact reason.
- **Traded** → the EXECUTION view, which shows what the model read and how old each input was.

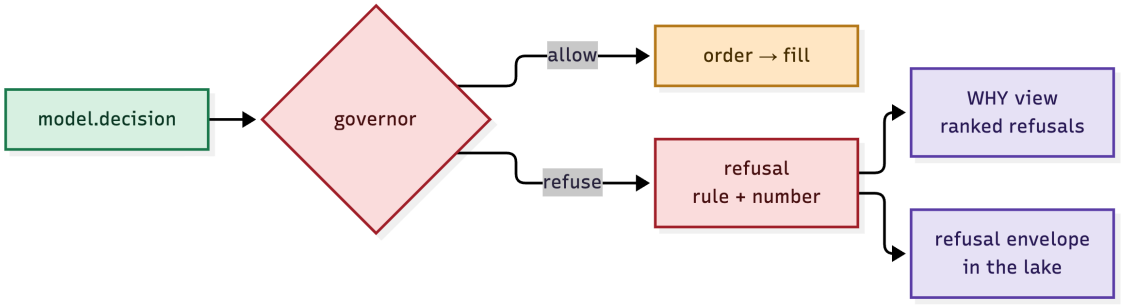


Figure F.2 — a refusal names the rule and the number, and is itself an envelope in the lake.

F.2.2 What the model actually read

The execution trace answers the narrowest, most useful question: *for this one fill, which raw envelopes did the model read, in what order, and how old were they when it acted?*

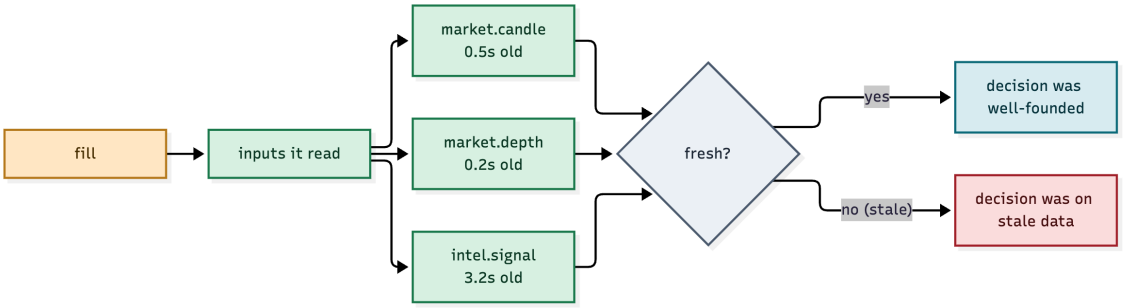


Figure F.3 — inputs are listed with their age at execution; a stale input is a finding, not a feeling.

Finding	Meaning
input 0.2s old	fresh — the decision was well-founded
input 3.2s old	still fresh for most topics
input 3200s old	stale — the model acted on old data

F.2.3 A worked refusal

```
model.decision NEARUSDT  side=buy  confidence=0.62
  verdict    REFUSED
  reason     stale signals: 3230s old (max 90s)
  pipeline   authority pass · keying pass · correlation pass · freshness pass
  refs       market.candle 0.5s · market.depth 0.2s (both fresh)
```

The freshness interceptor passed — the *envelope* was fresh. The refusal came from the model's own signal-age check. The market data was seconds old; the *signals* were 53 minutes old. The investigation lands on the real fault: a signal producer was silent for that symbol, and the model correctly refused to act on stale information.

F.3 Optimising the models

Optimisation is a loop, not a one-off. The same decoupling that makes the system observable makes it tuneable: because every model is a pure function and every outcome is a stamped packet, a parameter change can be measured against the exact same inputs.

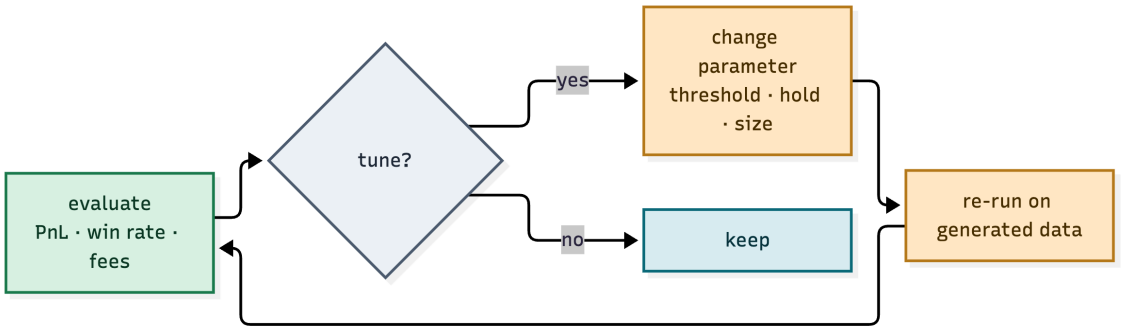


Figure F.4 — evaluate, tune, re-run on generated data, re-evaluate.

F.3.1 The measure

Metric	What it tells you
realised PnL	the bottom line
win rate	how often the model is right
fee drag	how much the 0.2% fee eats the edge
mean hold	whether exits fire as intended
largest loss	whether the stop is actually bounding losses

F.3.2 The probation and rotation

A model earns its place by surviving probation: its first N minutes of live trading. If the PnL falls below the floor, it is stopped, its post-mortem is written, and another model is tried.

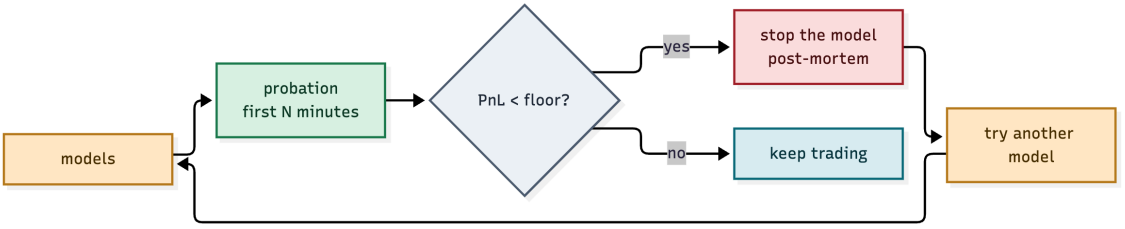


Figure F.5 — survive probation or be stopped; a stopped model is post-mortemed and replaced.

F.3.3 Tuning the forecast

The forecast is a function of three layers; tuning is calibrating their weights. The tier signal is the feedback: a weight change that raises the quality of tier-1 signals is kept, one that does not is reverted.

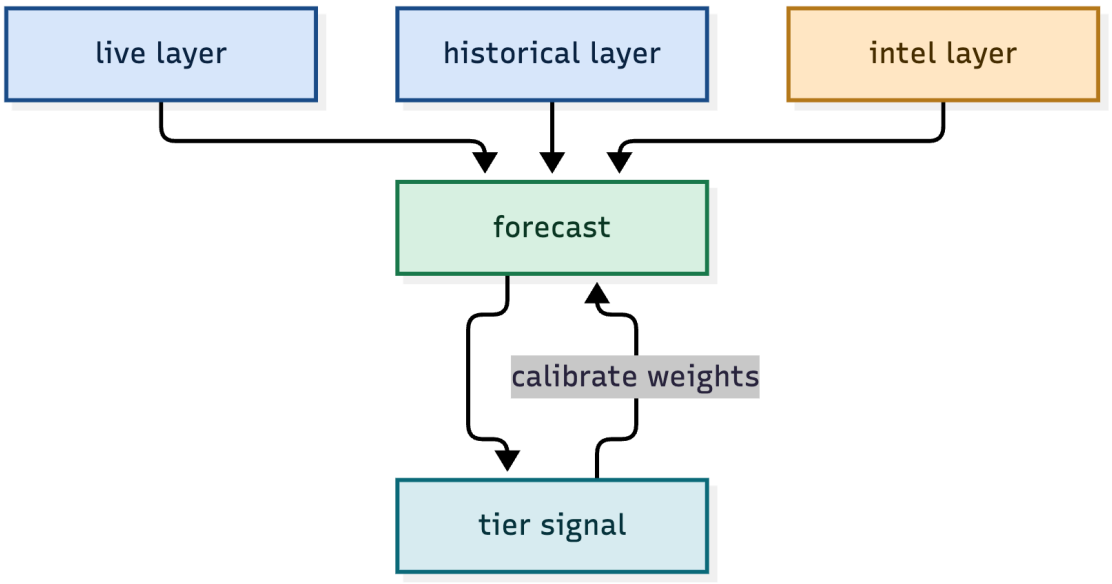


Figure F.6 — the tier signal feeds back into the layer weights.

F.3.4 A worked tuning

`rsi2` was buying at RSI < 10 and losing to fees. The investigation showed the winners were real but the losers were fee-sized. Tuning the threshold from <10 to <5 cut the low-quality entries, and the win rate rose. The change was measured against the *same* generated bars before and after — so the improvement is a number, not an opinion.

F.4 Absolute traceability

This is the fascinating part: **the platform is evidence**. Nothing is lost, nothing is inferred silently, and every step is linked by one correlation id.

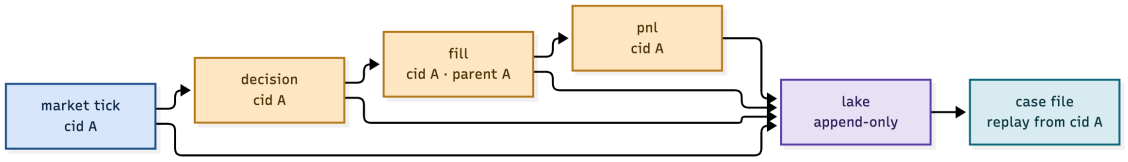


Figure F.7 — one cid follows the work from market tick to fill to pnl, into an append-only lake.

F.4.1 Why this is absolute

Property	What it means
append-only lake	history is never rewritten
monotonic generation	a gap is detectable, never hidden
correlation ids	every step links to its parent
derived refs are labelled	inferred lineage is never passed off as declared
refusals are recorded	"why not" is evidence, not a gap
case hash	two reports are comparable by fingerprint

F.4.2 The case file

For any decision, the system can produce a **case file**: the verdict, the inputs with ages, the pipeline stages, and a case hash that fingerprints the scope — so two copies can be compared and a changed one detected.

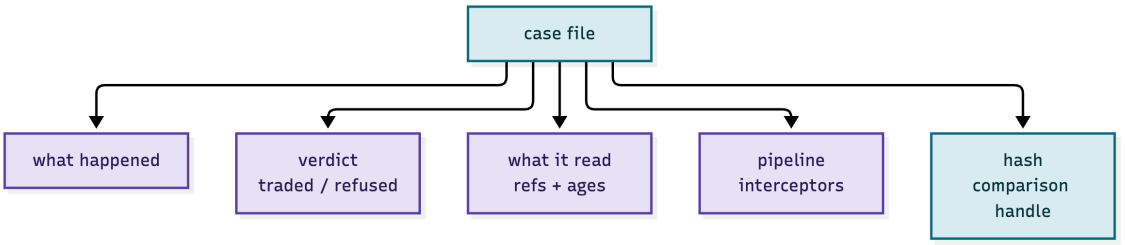


Figure F.8 — a case file is the decision, its inputs, its pipeline, and a hash.

F.4.3 Reconstructing a trade from a correlation id

```
$ resolve cid-8c50fc9388443f4e

  market.candle  SOLUSDT  09:02:01.123   (the trigger)
  model.decision SOLUSDT  buy  cid-8c50fc9388443f4e
```

```
  model.fill     SOLUSDT  buy  net +0.21%  parent cid-8c50fc9388443f4e
  model.pnl      donchian55  equity 5005.25  cid-8c50fc9388443f4e
```

From one id, the entire life of a trade is reassembled — the tick that triggered it, the decision, the fill, and the resulting pnl. That is what "absolute traceability" means: the record is complete enough to replay the trade, and honest enough to show its own gaps.

F.5 The X FILES, closed

The truth is out there — and in this system it is *literally* out there, in the lake, as a chain of stamped envelopes. Debugging is reading that chain. Optimising is measuring it. Traceability is the fact that the chain is complete and append-only. That is the reward for building decoupled: **every question is answerable, and every answer is evidence.**

15. Field dictionary and glossary

15.1 Envelope metadata

Field	Type	Meaning
`version`	int	envelope contract revision
`plane`	string	market, intel, model, risk, control, system
`topic`	string	the bus topic
`key`	string	the symbol, when it concerns one
`producer`	string	the component that computed it
`generation`	uint	the producer's counter; gaps mean loss
`cid`	string	correlation id
`computed_at`	timestamp	when produced — staleness gates use this
`received_at`	timestamp	when the recorder accepted it
`refs`	array	inputs with topic, key, generation, age_ms
`hops`	array	pipeline stages with outcome

15.2 Payload fields by topic

Topic	Fields
`model.decision`	engine, symbol, side, allowed, reason, confidence
`model.fill`	engine, symbol, side, entry, exit, gross_pct, net_pct, peak_pct, reason, held_s, notional, pnl_usd
`market.depth`	symbol, bids[], asks[], bid_qty, ask_qty, imbalance
`market.candle`	symbol, interval, t, o, h, l, c, v, q, Q
`risk.state`	snapshot{equity, gross_multiple, longs, shorts, per_symbol}

15.3 Glossary

Term	Meaning
envelope	the fixed carrier: data, meta, references
interceptor	a rule that runs before work, and can refuse
operator	the capability that produces a payload
transformer	a stage that changes an envelope's shape

correlation id	the identity that follows one piece of work
tier signal	a strength-ranked, pattern-confirmed decision
intel window	the book's bounded rolling signal history
lake	the recorded store of envelopes
imbalance	bid volume minus ask volume, normalised